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Glasgow passes the baton to Ahmedabad

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NEARBY



Vilathikulam MLA gets bail from High Court

CHENNAI
The Madras High Court on Monday granted bail to Vilathikulam DMK MLA, G.V. Markandayan, in a case registered against him for his reported remarks against Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay at a public event. » PAGE 2

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T.N. moves SC to press for release of Cauvery water

Application seeks direction to Karnataka to implement the CWMA's July 30 decision on release of water from Kabini, KRS reservoirs; Karnataka defying Cauvery tribunal orders, says Tamil Nadu

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Tamil Nadu government headed by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay moved the Supreme Court on Monday for a direction to the State of Karnataka to implement a Cauvery Water Management Authority (CWMA) decision of July 30 to ensure the release of 3,500 cusecs for 15 days from its reservoirs at Kabini and Krishnaraja Sagara (KRS).

Tamil Nadu's approach to the Supreme Court for the release of 4.536 tmc ft of water (at the rate of 3,500 cusecs for 15 days) on or before August 12 has come even as Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar said the water situation has become "slightly better" while urging Kan-



Water flows into Biligundlu, the first point of entry of the Cauvery into T.N., in Krishnagiri district on Monday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

nada organisations to withdraw their State-wide bandh call on August 13.

The Tamil Nadu application, finalised by senior advocates C.S. Vaidyanathan and G. Umapathy, and drafted by Tushar Nair, was filed by advocate-on-record B. Karunakaran.

The State urged the Su-

preme Court to direct the CWMA to issue an appropriate direction to Karnataka to make good, on a pro-rata basis, the shortfall at the inter-State point of Biligundlu for the period from June 1 to August 12, and in this regard release 26.954 tmc ft of water forthwith.

It further sought an or-

der to the CWMA to monitor the flows in the reservoirs of Karnataka every 10 days and ensure stipulated monthly/daily releases at Biligundlu.

'Orders defied'
The Tamil Nadu government said Karnataka had continued to defy the orders of the Cauvery Tribunal for allocation of water to its neighbour except a few times when there were inevitable surpluses in the reservoirs on account of floods.

The State argued that despite the CWMA intervention, total flows realised at Biligundlu from July 29 to August 2 were only in the range of 158 cusecs to 530 cusecs.

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Prashant Kishor breaches BJP's fortress in Bankipur

The Hindu Bureau
PATNA

Jan Suraa Party (JSP) founder Prashant Kishor scripted a major political upset in Bihar by defeating the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) candidate in the Bankipur Assembly byelection, a constituency represented for five consecutive terms by the BJP's national president Nitin Nabin. The BJP retained Manjalpur in Gujarat while the Congress held on to Madhya Pradesh's Datia in other Assembly byelections.

Mr. Kishor dedicated the victory to the people of Bankipur and appealed to the BJP's central leadership to change the Chief Minister of Bihar. The Bankipur seat had fallen vacant as Mr. Nabin gave it up upon his election to the Rajya Sabha and elevation as BJP chief.

The political strategist-turned-politician clinched victory over BJP candidate Neeraj Kumar Sinha by a



Winning entry: Jan Suraa Party chief Prashant Kishor celebrates his Bankipur bypoll victory with supporters in Patna on Monday. PTI

margin of 19,324 votes. He bagged 64,151 votes while Mr. Sinha finished with 44,827 votes. Rashtriya Janata Dal nominee Rekha Kumari secured the third position with 14,273 votes. A total of 25 candidates contested the election, with 646 voters choosing the NOTA option.

In the 2025 Assembly election, Mr. Nabin had defeated Ms. Kumari by a margin of 51,936 votes. He had secured 98,299 votes while Ms. Kumari polled 46,363 votes. The JSP's Vandana Kumari had re-

ceived 7,717 votes.

Throughout the 32 rounds of counting on Monday, Mr. Kishor, contesting an election for the first time, remained ahead in every round and held on to his lead until the final tally. Celebrations broke out at the JSP office in Patliputra Colony after the 10th round, when Mr. Kishor had established a lead of over 6,000 votes.

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Proposal for airport in Thanjavur deferred

Sunitha Sekar
CHENNAI

The proposed domestic airport at Thanjavur may not take off at the moment, according to the Ministry of Civil Aviation. Since the Tiruchi airport is very close to Thanjavur, it is not operationally viable for now, the Ministry has said.

The proposed civil enclave has not been found to be operationally viable; hence, it has been "deferred for the present", Minister of State for Civil Aviation Murlidhar Mohol has said.

He was responding to a question raised by DMK Member S. Kalyanasundaram in the Rajya Sabha as to whether the Centre had reviewed the progress of the proposed civil enclave

Since Tiruchi airport is very close to Thanjavur, it is not operationally viable, says the Centre

at the Thanjavur airport, whether it could be brought under the UDAN Scheme, and whether there was any timeline for commencement of commercial passenger flight operations.

Mr. Mohol said the Thanjavur airport, owned and operated by the Indian Air Force (IAF), was considered for flight operations under the Regional Connectivity Scheme (RCS)-UDAN.

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Staying afloat



Flood fury: People paddle through a flooded street in Kottayam, Kerala, on Monday. Despite a reduction in intensity, heavy showers continued to batter parts of the State for the third consecutive day, taking the rain-related death toll to 18. VISHNU PRATHAP (REPORT: PAGE 5)

Ex-WFI chief cleared in sexual harassment case

Ishita Mishra
NEW DELHI

A Delhi court on Monday acquitted Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh, former Bharatiya Janata Party MP and former Wrestling Federation of India (WFI) president, in a case concerning allegations of sexual harassment made against him by women wrestlers.

Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate Ashwini Panwar of the Rouse Avenue Courts also acquitted co-accused Vinod Tomar, former assistant secretary of the WFI. Advocate Rajiv Mohan, who represented Mr. Singh, confirmed to *The Hindu* that his client had received an "honourable acquittal".

Congress MLA and former Olympian Vinesh



Brij Bhushan Sharan Singh

Phogat said the women wrestlers would challenge the verdict before a higher court. In a post on X, she said it had taken "a lot of courage" for the wrestlers to stage protests and lodge an FIR against "a powerful leader of the ruling party". "We have not lost hope, and the wrestlers will continue their fight," she said.

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» PAGE 8

SC asks govt. to consider 'important' plea against Jantar Mantar as a site of protests

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday asked Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta to consult with Union government authorities on an "important" petition that Jantar Mantar is not the "right site" to hold protests.

"The petition says Jantar Mantar is not the right site anymore for such protests due to ingress-egress issue, supply of medical essentials, etc... I think this is important. Please take instructions, Mr. Solicitor. Issue notice and list this separately," Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, heading a three-judge Bench, addressed the law officer.



The petition flags logistical issues for mass demonstrations at the designated protest site in New Delhi. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

The petition, filed by Satish Chand Kaushik, represented by advocate Aakarshan Aditya, urged the discontinuation of Jantar Mantar as the ordinary designated venue for public protests and demonstrations, and to designate Ramlila Maidan, or another

sufficiently large ground, as the principal protest venue for the national capital. Mr. Aditya argued that Jantar Mantar was designated in an earlier era for identifiable, and manageable demonstrations, and to designate Ramlila Maidan, or another

the petitioner counsel said, in a reference to the police crackdown on protests led by the Cockroach Janta Party at Jantar Mantar recently. "They (the government) know how to handle it. If they cannot, come to us," Chief Justice Kant said.

The petition has come days after the court's repeated observations upholding the right of citizens to peaceful and lawful protest. The court had, however, balanced the freedom to express dissent with the right to not break the peace or occupy public space.

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'STATES CAN CLOSE FIRS'
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Thirupparankundram row: SC agrees to hear T.N.'s plea, but refuses interim relief

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday decided to examine a petition filed by the Tamil Nadu government, headed by Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay, challenging orders passed by the Madras High Court on lighting a lamp at a stone pillar near a dargah on the Thirupparankundram hill.

A Bench, headed by Justice Aravind Kumar, issued notice to the Madurai Collector, the Joint Commissioner of the Hindu Religious and Charitable Endowments (HR&CE) Department, Sikkandar Badhusah Dargah, Hazarath Suitan, Sikkandar Badhsha Avuliya Dargah, the Ar-



Legal challenge: The Tamil Nadu government has challenged the Madras High Court's order on lighting a lamp at a stone pillar near a dargah on the Thirupparankundram hill. FILE PHOTO

chaeological Survey of India, the Tamil Nadu Waqf Board, and the petitioner in the High Court, Rama Ravikumar, and others on a plea filed by the Commissioner, HR&CE, Chennai.

The State, represented by senior advocate Jaideep

Gupta, said the High Court had created a new tradition. It was not up to the courts to do it.

The Bench queried whether there was a prevailing tradition of lighting the lamp on the pillar. The State said there were no

historical records of lighting the lamp on the pillar. "A dangerous situation has been propped up. If it is done once, it will be repeated in the years after," Mr. Gupta said.

The Bench refused to grant any interim relief and said the case would be heard comprehensively after the respondents filed their affidavits in six weeks. It listed the case for hearing in eight weeks.

In January, the High Court's Division Bench had confirmed a Single Judge Bench order directing the Subramaniya Swamy Temple management to light the Karthigai Deepam at 'deepathoon' (the stone pillar) atop the hill, besides the usual places.

INBRIEF



Football coaching organised for over 300 school students

LatentView Analytics organised a practical football session for over 300 students of 10 government schools at the Tagore Film Centre, National Film Development Corporation, on Monday. The programme was organised as part of the Chennai Kaalpandhu League (CKL), a grassroots football tournament now in its sixth year, encouraging young footballers to dive deep into the tactics that shaped key moments of FIFA World Cup 2026. Coaches from Chennaiyin FC guided them. Pramad Jandhyala, co-founder, LatentView, said, “When we started the CKL programme, the goal was not only to create the opportunity to play football, but also to build confidence through sports.”

M.A.J. Vinod assumes charge as head of BIS Southern Region

M.A.J. Vinod, Scientist-F, assumed charge as Deputy Director-General, Southern Region, Bureau of Indian Standards (BIS), Chennai, on Monday. He previously served as the Senior Director and Head of the Southern Regional Laboratory, BIS Chennai. The Southern Regional Office of BIS, headquartered in Chennai, oversees its activities in Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Karnataka, Andhra Pradesh, Telangana, the Union Territory of Puducherry, Andaman and Nicobar Islands, Lakshadweep, and Goa.

Text & Context and Science

Weekday features on *The Hindu* epaper (epaper.thehindu.com) carries explainers, special articles and quizzes. In the latest issue (August 4, Tuesday), the following explainers are available:

- Why is PoK rocked by protests?
[newsth.live/PoKprotests](#)
- Why you get better care when you stop nodding and start asking why
[newsth.live/patientrelations](#)

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Vijay visits industrial hub in Sriperumbudur

The Chief Minister visits Saint-Gobain, a glass manufacturing company, and takes a guided tour of the glass-making process. He also went to Renault Nissan car manufacturing facility

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay on Monday visited Saint-Gobain, a glass manufacturing company, at Sriperumbudur, where he took a guided tour of the glass-making process. He also planted a sapling on the company's premises. Later, the Chief Minister visited the Renault Nissan manufacturing facility, where he test-drove one of the company's SUVs. Thousands of people lined both sides of the road to catch a glimpse of the Chief Minister, who was also expected to visit other industrial units in the SIP-COT Industrial Estate.



Marking his presence: Chief Minister C. Joseph Vijay signing on a sheet of glass at Saint-Gobain's manufacturing plant in Sriperumbudur on Monday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT



34-year-old man killed after being hit by train

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

D. Kannan, 34, was killed after being hit by an express train at Ennore railway station on Sunday. The Government Railway Police said Kannan, a

daily wage worker, was crossing the tracks after dropping his father off at the station when the train hit him. He sustained a head injury and died on the spot. Passers-by informed the police, who sent his body for a post-mortem.

Treat water as infrastructure that must be built, paid for: CEA

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chief Economic Adviser to the Government of India V. Anantha Nageswaran on Monday said water should be treated as infrastructure that “must be planned, built, and paid for”. He called for a policy that did not price water at zero and treat it as limitless. Addressing the special plenary session of CII Tamil Nadu Infrastructure Summit 2026 in Chennai, Mr. Nageswaran said: “The answer is to treat water the way we have finally learnt to treat roads and power: as infrastructure that must

be planned, built, and paid for. We need a water buffer storage so that a good monsoon carries us through a bad one.” He further said: “We price water at zero, so we treat it as limitless. So we waste it, and we under-build for it. And then, we are shocked when it runs out. The thing we call free is the thing we destroy. This is not a paradox. It is a policy choice, and it can be chosen differently.” Mr. Nageswaran also listed the floor space index as the second trap, one that was less visible than the first. “We hold the floor space index – the amount



M.V. Satish, adviser to CMD, Larsen & Toubro Ltd.; P. Ravichandran, chairman, CII Southern Region; Chief Economic Adviser Anantha Nageswaran; and C. Devarajan, chairman, CII Tamil Nadu, at Tamil Nadu Infrastructure Summit 2026 on Monday. S.R. RAGHUNATHAN

one may build on a given plot – far below what other cities around the world allow. If we cannot build upward, we spread outward.

Every square metre of built space then ends up carrying more land beneath it, and land grows scarcer and also dearer. When land is

that dear, the cheapest plot left is often an old tank or a filled-in pond, the very catchment that once held our water,” he said. “Underpricing does not help the poor. It helps whoever already holds the connection. The household with the piped supply pays a pittance. The household without one buys from the tanker at several times the rate. Cheap water for the connected is, in effect, a subsidy that reaches the comfortable more than the poor it is meant to help. If we get the pricing honest, the genuinely vulnerable can be protected directly and, more precise-

ly, the asset earns enough to reach those who do not yet have it, he added. C. Devarajan, chairman, CII Tamil Nadu & Managing Director URC Construction (P) Ltd.; Mohan Ramanathan, convener of T.N. Infrastructure Panel and Managing Director, Advanced Construction Technologies Private Ltd.; P. Ravichandran, chairman, CII Southern Region, and president, Danfoss India; M.V. Satish, adviser to Chairman & Managing Director (CMD), Larsen & Toubro Ltd.; and J. Murugavel, vice chairman, CII Tamil Nadu, and Founder & CEO, Matrimony.com, participated.

Timings
CHENNAI

TUESDAY, AUG. 04

RISE 05:55 SET 18:35

RISE 22:28 SET 10:27

WEDNESDAY, AUG. 05

RISE 05:56 SET 18:35

RISE 23:13 SET 11:21

THURSDAY, AUG. 06

RISE 05:56 SET 18:34

RISE 00:00 SET 12:19

Chennai Weather	max	min
Thiruvallur	37	26
Chennai Airport	37	27
Chennai City	37	25

Chennai Airport Today
36°C Weather will be very warm and uneasy. Night will also be comfortable. Light to moderate rain and thunder-showers likely.

Chennai Airport Tomorrow
35°C Morning will be comfortable. Day will be warm. Light to moderate rain and thunder-showers may occur.

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THE HINDU
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NOTICE INVITING E-TENDERS.
eproc.punjab.gov.in

Tender Ref: PETS/CETP/Q&M/2026-27/01

The Administrative Officer, Punjab Effluent Treatment Society for Tanneries, 58-Leather Complex, Kapurthala Road, Jalandhar, on behalf of Deputy Commissioner, Jalandhar-cum-Chairman, Interim Committee, Punjab Effluent Treatment Society for Tanneries invites bids in Electronic Tendering System for the Operation & Maintenance of 5 MLD capacity Common Effluent Treatment Plant for five years from the date of the work award from reputed agencies as per eligibility criteria mentioned in DNIT. The bid document is available online and bids are to be submitted online through e-procurement portal <http://eproc.punjab.gov.in> only. Bids submitted manually will not be accepted.

S. N.	Name of Work	Contract Price (in Rs.) Per kilo litre.	1 Earnest money deposit, 2 Processing fees 3 Tender Form fees	Period of Contract.	Last date of bid submission	Date of opening of tender
1	2	3	4	5	6	7
	Operation & Maintenance of tanneries waste water effluent at CETP of 5 MLD on continuous basis.	To be quoted by the bidders.	1. Rs. 25 Lacs. 2. As applicable 3. Rs. 5000/-	5 Years.	25.08.2026 13:00 Hrs.	26.08.2026 At 15:00 Hrs.

Pre-bid meeting: on 17th August, 2026 at 12:30 pm at PETS meeting room, 58-Leather Complex, Jalandhar (Punjab).

For detailed terms & conditions please visit website www.eproc.punjab.gov.in

Administrative Officer, PETS
For Deputy Commissioner, Jalandhar-cum-Chairman, Interim Committee, PETS for Tanneries, e-mail: p.pets@yahoo.co.in Mob: 98147 16229

1719/12/2026-27/13858

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Telephone: 0135 - 2763808, Fax 0135-2763508
CIN No.340101UR2001SGC025866, Website: www.ujvn.co.in

Notice Inviting e-Tender Dated 03.08.2026
Office of the Executive Engineer (Solar), "Ujjwal", Maharani Bagh, G.M.S. Road, UJVN Ltd., Dehradun, invites Online tariff based competitive bid (RIP) of Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) on BOOT basis under partial VGF Scheme through PSDF from interested parties. Summary of bid (RIP) document is given below:
Bid Identification Nos.: T-01/EE(Solar)/2026-27
Name of the Work : Setting-up of 90 MW/225 MWh Standalone Battery Energy Storage System (BESS) near Chilla HEP, District-Pauri Garhwal, Uttarakhand.
Date for availability of bid document on the portal : 04-08-2026 from 16:00 Hrs.
Last Date / Time of Receipt of bid on the portal : 25-08-2026 till 16:00 Hrs.
Detail of subsequent addendum/corrigendum/cancelation etc. may be obtained from the website.
Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal <http://uktenders.gov.in>.
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TICEL invites e-Tender for the following work at TICEL Bio Park - I & II, Chennai Date: 04.08.2026

Sr. No.	e-Tender No.	Description of tender	Closing Date
1.	TICEL/P2/PMC/2026-27/08	Selection of Project Management Consultancy for Structural Rehabilitation, Strengthening and associated Repair Works at Basement in TICEL BIO PARK Phase-II	19.08.2026

For more details and participation in the above e-tender, please visit the website <https://www.intenders.gov.in>. Last date for online submission of duly filled tender documents is 19.08.2026 on or before 3 PM. TICEL Bio Park Ltd reserves the right to accept/ reject any one/all tenders without assigning any reason.

DIPR/2432/Tender/2026 **Managing Director**

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THE HINDU

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CINEMA ♦ ARTS ♦ EVENTS

MUSIC DANCE DRAMA

The Music Academy Madras
56th SPIRIT OF YOUTH FESTIVAL OF MUSIC AND DANCE. Today: At the Kasturi Srinivasan Hall, 6 p.m. to 7.15 p.m. Prithvi Bhaskar (Vocal), Amrutha Varshini K S (Violin), Aprameya H S (Mridangam) – 7.30 p.m. to 9 p.m. – Bharatanatyam by Yukthi Udupa (Disciple of Pravitha Ashok). Members of the Academy are specially invited. The festival sponsored by SUNDRAM FASTENERS LIMITED and dedicated to the memory of Smt. Ambujam Krishna.

Sri Vishnu Mahan Foundation, Chennai in association with Bharatiya Vidya Bhavan, Chennai Kendra celebrates "Sri Krishna Utsavam" from 31.7.2026 to 5.8.2026.

Today: 4th August: 5.45 pm: Mohiniyattam by Dr.Gopika Varma, 7.00 pm: Bharatanatyam by Smt.Padmini Krishnamurthy & Students, Sri Saraswathy Gana Nilayam Trust,Prasadam distribution at 8.30 pm.
Tomorrow: 5th August: 5.30 pm: Discourse by U.Ve. Sri Dhamal Ramakrishnan. Valet Parking available. All are Welcome.

Sponsored by: **Nalli**

Narada Gana Sabha
Ph: 24993201
Today Mini Hall (Swami Haridhos Giri Hall) - 6.30 pm - Talent Promotion Concerts - Hari Dharmarajan Endowment - Surya Sriram, Srikrishnan Subramanian, G.N. Bhuvan. Tomorrow - 6.30 p.m - Mahanya Shree. All are welcome.

Rasika Ranjani Sabha Foundation, Ch-4.
Today at 05.00 p.m, Inauguration of YUVOTSAV - 2026 by Shri Bharat Sundar - 06.00 p.m Nama Sankirtanam by disciples of Gayathri Mahesh. Ph. 8610357987. Rasikas Welcome.

MISCELLANEOUS

Sri Krishna Sweets
TODAY 4th AUGUST 2026, 6.30 PM in association with Sri Vittal Rukmini Samsthan Sri Radha Kalyana Mahotsava Seva Committee, Nanganallur Vedaharathi, Chennai

nama saagar
Nama Sankeerthanam by Brahmasri Sri Vittaldas Maharaj

Hindu Colony Chellammal Vidyalaya Senior Secondary School Nanganallur, Chennai
TOMORROW 6th August 6.30 PM Chromepet Cultural Academy Indira Gandhi Cross Street, Off Radha Nagar Main Road, Radha Nagar, Chromepet, Chennai
For more details contact | ALL ARE WELCOME
18001022343

Raja Annamalaipuram Bhakta Jana Sabha (Founded by Dharmathma Sri V. Vaidyasubramania Iyer)
23, Sringeri Mutt Road R. A. Puram Chennai-28 SRIMAD BHAGHAVADA SAPTHAHAM By Dr Smt. SUDHA SESHAYAN 6.15 pm to 8.00 pm From 3/8/2026 To 9/8/2026 (Monday to Sunday) at Sringeri Pravachana Mandiram, 23, Sringeri Mutt Road, R A Puram Ch-28 (opposite Mandaveli Railway Station) All Are Welcome.

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INBRIEF



Lions Club distributes cash assistance and scholarships

The Lions Club District 3241F distributed scholarships, cash assistance, and health machines during the office-bearers' installation ceremony held at Hotel Greenpark in Vadapalani. Judge and Judicial Member of the National Company Law Appellate Tribunal, Justice N. Seshasayee, distributed welfare assistance comprising educational scholarships, cash assistance for patients, and a health machine, as part of social welfare projects. Lions District Governor Uma Anilkumar also participated.

Nakkeeran Gopal booked for remarks on Karur stampede

Senior journalist Nakkeeran Gopal has been booked by the Cyber Crime Wing of the Greater Chennai Police for allegedly making critical remarks about the Karur stampede. Mr. Gopal is the editor and publisher of the Tamil political investigative magazine *Nakkheeran*. The case was registered based on a complaint lodged by an individual named Nandakumar, who alleged that Mr. Gopal made remarks that could disturb public peace during a debate on the Karur stampede on a YouTube channel. It may be recalled that on September 27, 2025, at least 41 people were killed and around 100 others injured in a stampede during a political rally in Karur.

GCC publishes list of top 100 property tax defaulters

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The Greater Chennai Corporation (GCC), on Monday, published the list of the top 100 property tax defaulters on its website, as part of efforts to improve tax collection.

A press release said 100 property owners together owed the GCC ₹31.39 crore, with individual arrears ranging from ₹8 lakh to ₹4.80 crore.

The GCC said property tax, its principal source of revenue, is used to fund civic infrastructure and essential services, including solid waste management, maintenance of parks and roads, and disease prevention programmes.

The civic body said it had been undertaking various measures to recover outstanding dues from property owners, including issuing demand notices and affixing to buildings notices indicating pending tax arrears.

It urged property owners with pending dues to remit the outstanding tax at the earliest to support the implementation of civic infrastructure projects and delivery of public services across the city.

WRD proposes short-term flood mitigation works in city ahead of Northeast monsoon

The department has proposed 20 flood mitigation projects in Chennai basin for implementation during this financial year; it has proposed to carry out the works on priority as a special drive

WATER WATCH

K. Lakshmi
CHENNAI

In an effort to improve Chennai's flood resilience, the Water Resources Department (WRD) plans to begin a series of short-term projects to rehabilitate water bodies and remove bottlenecks in waterways, ahead of the Northeast monsoon.

The department has proposed about 20 flood mitigation projects in Chennai basin for implementation during this financial year. With the major works expected to take a few months to commence after the Tamil Nadu Assembly approves the Budget, the department has proposed to implement schemes on priority as a special drive.

Sources in the WRD said the department has proposed projects to the State government at an estimated cost of ₹400 crore.



Precautionary measure: The WRD would remove obstructions to free flow of floodwater in major waterways and look to complete the work in two months. FILE PHOTO

While the major schemes await government nod, the department would carry out works to reduce flooding under the State Disaster Mitigation Fund.

Works would be carried out to remove bottlenecks obstructing free flow of floodwater in major waterways, including the Cooum. Flood protection walls would be built along waterways, including the Araniyar and South Buckingham Canal, to prevent inundation in surrounding localities. For instance, old causeways and bridges across the Cooum river as

in Adayalampattu and on Avadi-Poonamallee Road would be dismantled.

There are also plans to rehabilitate water bodies and strengthen flood management infrastructure by building flood regulators. As part of its strategy of controlled water release, the department plans to lower storage through flood regulators ahead of heavy rainfall. Water bodies, including Pilaipakkam and Pondur Periya Eri in Sriperumbudur taluk and a few water bodies in Avadi, have been identified for restoration and installa-

tion of flood regulators.

The department aims to complete the work in two months. Construction of a flood protection wall along Nattu Kalvai, the surplus channel of Thiruneermalai Periyar Eri that carries floodwater to the Adyar river, is among the proposed projects.

Residents said their long-pending demands must be taken up during the upcoming Budget session. B. Saravanan, treasurer, Federation of Thiruneermalai Residents' Welfare Association said the channel had been affected by encroachments and sewage pollution. Citing a response obtained under the Right to Information Act, he said a retaining wall is planned along Nattu Kalvai at a cost of around ₹44 crore.

The department must consider deepening narrow stretches of the channel to prevent flooding in areas such as Saraswathypuram Extension and Temple Town.

Five from Chennai killed in car crash near Madurai

The Hindu Bureau
MADURAI

Five members of a family from Chennai were killed when their car collided with several vehicles and rolled over multiple times on the Madurai-Tiruchi Highway at Thumbapatti in the early hours of Monday.

The police identified the deceased as K. Sriram, 34, of Chennai, who was driving the car; his brother, Balaji; his mother, Rajamery; his wife, Ranchana; and his 18-month-old daughter, Kiruthiga. Sriram's father, V. Kanagaraj, 55, who was also in the car; bike riders R. Rathinam, 40, and C. Murugan, 55, of Sivaganga; and the occupant of another car, J. Prakash, 50, of Madurai, were injured.

The police suspected that Sriram, who was driving the car from Chennai to Madurai, lost control of the wheel while speeding and the car hit a two-wheeler and then the median. In the impact of the collision, the car rolled over multiple times before it hit the wall of a bridge.

Madurai Collector Nishanth Krishna visited the accident site and the hospital where the injured were admitted to.

4 from Haryana held for malpractice in IAF exam

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

The police arrested four persons from Haryana for allegedly impersonating candidates and using wireless devices while appearing for an Indian Air Force (IAF) clerk recruitment examination held at Avadi on Sunday.

The arrested were identified as Gaurav, 21, and Anil, 27, who were allegedly involved in impersonation, and Sawan, 25, and Deepak, 24, who were allegedly caught using electronic devices.

The examination was conducted to fill four clerk posts, with around 1,000 candidates appearing for it. Police sources said that while checking the candidates' hall tickets, IAF officials noticed that a hall ticket carried the name and photograph of a candidate identified as Aman Kumar. However, the person who appeared for the examination did not match the photograph.

Suspecting foul play, the officials detained and questioned him. During the inquiry, they found that Gaurav had allegedly impersonated Aman

Kumar and appeared for the examination on his behalf.

The officials then took Gaurav to the room where he was staying and found four bags. They learnt that he had come to Avadi along with three other persons. Further inquiry revealed that another person, identified as Anil, had allegedly impersonated Sunil Kumar and appeared for the examination in his place.

Apart from the two impersonators, two other Haryana natives, identified as Sawan and Deepak Kumar, were allegedly caught using tiny wireless devices inserted into their ears to receive assistance during the examination.

After completing their preliminary inquiry, the IAF officials handed the four accused over to Muthapudupet police, who arrested them.

Police sources said the investigation revealed that the two impersonators had allegedly received an advance of ₹50,000 each for appearing the examination on behalf of the candidates. They were promised the remaining payment after completing the examination and securing a pass.

Webinar on vascular health to be conducted tomorrow

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Kauvery Hospital, in association with *The Hindu*, will organise a webinar on vascular health on August 5 ahead of National Vascular Day, observed on August 6.

Titled 'Vascular Health: Prevention, Healing and Limb Protection', the webinar, part of Kauvery Hospital's wellness series, will be



held at 11.30 a.m. The session aims to raise awareness of vascular health, emphasising the importance of ear-

The webinar, to be held at 11.30 a.m., aims to emphasise the importance of preventive care

ly detection, preventive care, and timely treatment to help prevent serious complications.

Sekar N., Chief Vascular and Endovascular Surgeon,

Kauvery Hospital, Chennai, will speak on understanding vascular health and the need for early diagnosis and intervention.

Arunagiri Viruthagiri, consultant vascular and endovascular surgeon, Kauvery Hospital, Tiruchi, will discuss risk factors, early detection, and treatment options.

Anushri S., Consultant Endocrinologist, Kauvery Hos-

pital, Salem, will speak on the link between diabetes and vascular disease and measures to reduce diabetes-related complications.

Zubeda Hamid, Senior Assistant Editor, *The Hindu*, will moderate the webinar.

Registration is open at newsth.live/ THKAVE or scan the QR code.



CHENNAI METROPOLITAN DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
OFFICE OF THE SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER-I,
CONSTRUCTION WING, FIRST FLOOR, 'E' ROAD, KOYAMBEDU, CHENNAI - 600 107

E- TENDER NOTICE Date : 03.08.2026

Tender is invited by the Superintending Engineer-I, Construction Wing, CMDA, Koyambedu, Chennai – 107 under Two Cover System for the work of **“Operation and Maintenance of Chengalpattu Bus Terminal at Chengalpattu for CMDA on Public Private Partnership (PPP) mode for a period of 15years”.**

Tender Notice No.	01/2026-2027 dt. 03. 08.2026
Last date & Time of receipt of E-tenders	15.09.2026 upto 3.00 pm
Downloading the tender document by free of cost	10.08.2026 to 15.09.2026 upto 3.00 pm
For further details visit website	http://tntenders.gov.in

Superintending Engineer-I
CW, CMDA, Koyambedu, Chennai - 600 107

DIPRI/2438Tender/2026



Ministry Of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises
MSME - TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT CENTRE - (CDCE)
An Autonomous body under Ministry of MSME, Govt of India
A-11 Industrial Area, Ferozshah 282503, www.cdceindia.net

AI & CHATGPT TRAINING
AI Tools & Chat GPT

Course Duration **(ONLINE)** Date: 08 & 09 August 2026
2 Days Time : 5:00 PM to 8:30 PM

Course Content: Introduction to AI Tools for Marketing, Modern prompting technique (R-C-O-F), Generative engine optimization basics for your website, Social Media Poster Creation, Product Photograph Generation, Ad Copywriting, Email Series Creation, Video Generation, Content Creation Automation, Presentation Creation, Infographic Creation, Ad Targeting, Market Research, Competitor Research, Digital Marketing Strategy, Content Planner Creation. Tools Covered: ChatGPT, Claude AI, Canva AI, Gemini AI, Napkin AI, Copy.ai, AI-PH for ChatGPT

Fees - Rs.3,540/- (Study material in soft copy shall be provided)
Coordinator: 9318676612, 9953920498, 8168984069
FEE PAYMENT ONLY IN MSME/CDCE ACCOUNT
Government of India certificate will be awarded



Ministry Of Micro, Small & Medium Enterprises
MSME - TECHNOLOGY DEVELOPMENT CENTRE - (CDCE)
An Autonomous body under Ministry of MSME, Govt of India
A-11 Industrial Area, Ferozshah 282503, www.cdceindia.net

HOW TO START YOUR OWN STARTUP
How to Raise Funds for New Business or Existing Business

Course Duration **(ONLINE)** Date: 09 & 16 August 2026
2 Days Time : 5:00 PM to 8:30 PM

Course Content: 10 Steps to becoming a successful entrepreneur, How to Set Up/New business with Govt. Support and Policies, Startup India Seed Fund Scheme, Basics of Bankable Project Report, Marketing Concept, Effective Business Plan, Financial Management, Risk Management, Building Block, Negotiation Skills, GST & Business Formation Process, Case Study on Business Failure, INCREASING PRODUCTIVITY OF ENTREPRENEURS

Fees - Rs.3,540/- (Study material in soft copy shall be provided)
Coordinator: 9603769900, 9953920498, 8168984069
FEE PAYMENT ONLY IN MSME/CDCE ACCOUNT
Government of India certificate will be awarded



GREATER BENGALURU AUTHORITY
Office of the Executive Engineer-3,
Project Implementation Unit, 9th Floor, Jayanagara Shopping Complex, 4th Block, Jayanagara, Bengaluru - 560011.

No: EE-3/GBA/PIU/TEND/01/2026-27 **Date: 03-08-2026**

SHORT TERM TENDER NOTIFICATION
(Two Cover System) (Through GOK KPP Portal Only)

The Executive Engineer-3, Project Implementation Unit, GBA, Bengaluru invites Request for Proposal from interested Persons / Firms for the below work.

Sl. No.	Name of the Work
1	Providing, Supply and Installation of Various Necessary Facilities such as Shamiyana, Stage, Sound System, Lightings, Cardamom Garland, Shalu, Dry Fruits, Snacks, Fireworks-Pyrotechnics, Bands, Awards, Cultural Representation Parade, Themed Stalls and Other Facilities for “Freedom Habba-2026” and various Programs to be Celebrated on 15-08-2026 at Vidhana Soudha Premises. Amount Put to Tender (Rs. in Lakhs): 500.00 (Excluding GST & Other Applicable Taxes), EMD Amount (in Rs.): 7,50,000.00

Calendar of Events: 1) Tender Document may be downloaded from the GOK Karnataka Public Procurement Portal Website: <https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in> from **05-08-2026 at 10.00 Hrs.** 2) Last Date and Time for Filled Tenders Submitted through Karnataka Public Procurement Portal on **11-08-2026 upto 16.30 Hours.** 3) Date of Opening of Technical Bids: **12-08-2026 at 17.00 Hours.** Financial bids will be opened only if the conditions in the Technical bid are met and Bids not fulfilling the conditions will be rejected. 4) Date of Opening of Financial Bids: **12-08-2026 after 17.30 Hours.** Further details can be had from the above office.

**Sd/- Executive Engineer-3,
Project Implementation Unit, GBA.**

OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH



Wg. Cdr. P. GOPIKUMAR (Retd.)
15.10.1938 - 03.08.2026
Loyal and doing spouse, father and friend; a patriot, voracious reader, dog dad and Ranji trophy cricketer. Celebrating your simplicity, lightheartedness, fun-loving nature and a life well-lived!
Wife Jayashree, daughter Vandana, son-in-law Senthil, friend Valshnavi and a loving network of family and friends from The Banyan!
Contact: TheGopikumars@gmail.com

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

32nd Death Anniversary


Shri. M. D. Bhashiyam
Retd. Appl. Assistant Commissioner(CT)
Remembering you with love, We continue to be inspired and guided by your high ideals.
Family Members
Sri Dhanalakshmi Bhashiyam Trust
Sri & Co

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES



We regret to announce the demise of our father
Shri V.N.Natarajan (91)
on 03.08.2026
Contact: 6369695804, 9444483707

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

FIRST ANNIVERSARY
God shall wipe away all tears from their eyes; and there shall be no more death, neither sorrow, nor crying, neither shall there be any more pain.
- Rev 21:4


Dr. E Chellappa, MVS
Former Dy Director of Animal Husbandry, Chennai
DOB 21.01.1933 - DOD 04.08.2025
You are loved beyond words and missed beyond measure - Fondly remembered by Family members



बिहार सरकार
(मद्यनिषेध शाखा)

समाहरणालय, जमुई
वाहन स्वामी अंतिम नोटिस-सह-अल्पकालीन आम नीलामी सूचना

एतद द्वारा सर्वसाधारण को सूचित किया जाता है कि बिहार मद्यनिषेध एवं उत्पाद अधिनियम, 2016 तथा बिहार मद्यनिषेध और उत्पाद (संशोधन) अधिनियम, 2018 में जप्त वाहनों के अधिहरण वाद में ममनीय न्यायालय समाहर्ता, जमुई एवं अन्य प्राधिकृत न्यायालय, जमुई के द्वारा अधिग्रहित वाहनों का सार्वजनिक नीलामी (Public Auction) मद्यनिषेध कार्यालय केमरा, जमुई में दिनांक-**24.08.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे** से तथा आवश्यकानुसार अगले कार्यदिवस को सम्पन्न किया जाएगा एवं शेष बचे वाहनों की द्वितीय नीलामी दिनांक-**07.09.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे** से सम्पन्न किया जाएगा तथा शेष बचे वाहनों की तृतीय नीलामी दिनांक-**18.09.2026 को प्रातः 11:00 बजे** से सम्पन्न किया जाएगा। नीलामी प्रक्रिया अपर समाहर्ता, जमुई के अध्यक्षता में गतिवत नीलामी समिति के पर्यवेक्षण में सम्पन्न होगी। यदि कोई वाहन स्वामी अपने वाहन को नियमानुसार फेनाल्टी पर मुक्त करना चाहें तो नीलामी की तिथि तक आवेदन कर सकते हैं। वाहन स्वामी के द्वारा अपर सखन न्यायालय में मामला दर्ज कर किया गया है या विचारार्थी है तो वे अपने मामलों में सहाय के साथ इनकी सूचना वाहन स्वामी को नीलामी समिति के सखन या उत्पाद, कार्यालय, जमुई में नीलामी के निवासित स्थिति के पूर्व अवगत नीलामी प्रक्रिया सम्पन्न होने तक वापस सार्वजनिक करने के उपरान्त संबंधित वाहनों की नीलामी नहीं की जायेगी। अपर संबंधित वाहन स्वामी द्वारा वाहन को मुक्त करने हेतु आवेदन किया जाता है तो नीलामी को रोकते हुए वाहन स्वामी को नियमानुसार मुक्त करने की कार्यवाई की जायेगी। नीलामी हेतु वाहनों की विस्तृत जानकारी निम्न प्रकार है :-

क्र. सं.	अधिहरण वाद संख्या/वर्ष	वाहन का नाम	वाहन काई संख्या	अधिग्रहण का नाम/वाहन मालिक का नाम	वाहन का प्रकार	वाहन का निबंधन संख्या/वेधिस नं०/इंजन नं०	वाहन का निर्माण वर्ष	न्यूनतम मूल्य (Minimum Floor Price)	अग्रपन की राशि (20%)
1	115/2024	मद्यनिषेध	JAM-276/24	NAGAJOTHI K, S/O-KANNAN, HOUSE NO. & STREET NAME- 27 KULATHU STREET, VILLAGE- THENI ALLINAGARAM THENI, P.S.- THENI, STATE - TAMIL NADU, PIN-625531	HERO PASSION XPRO MOTORCYCLE	Reg. No.-TN-60AB-6267 Chassis No.-MBLJA12ACGGL03299 Eng. No.-JA12ABGGL04857	2017	24000	4800

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समाहर्ता, जमुई

विस्तृत जानकारी state.bihar.gov.in/prdbihar से प्राप्त की जा सकती है।

PR. No.009179 (Excise) 2026-27

नशे की मार, बर्बाद करे सुखी परिवार।



GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
Lokseva Bhawan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
PT-1HE-SCH-POLICY-003-2026/41754/HE., Bhubaneswar, Dated:03.08.2026

Corrigendum-III

NOTICE INVITING RFP FOR PROCUREMENT, SUPPLY, INSTALLATION & COMMISSIONING OF LABORATORY EQUIPMENT & ITS ACCESSORIES FOR BERHAMPUR UNIVERSITY, GANJAM UNDER REGIONAL DIRECTORATE OF EDUCATION, BERHAMPUR APPROVED UNDER PM-USHA.

RFP No. PM-USHA:02/2026 **Date: 02.07.2026**

Sl. No.	RFP Cl.No.	Page No.	Description as per RFP	Modified vide Corrigendum I, dated 20.07.2026	Now Modified Provisions
1	DATA SHEET (Sl. No.7 & 8)	5	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 23/07/2026 till 4:00 PM (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 07/08/2026 till 4:00 PM (Registered Post & Speed Post only)	Last Date & Time for Submission of Bid - 24/08/2026 till 4:00 PM (Registered Post & Speed Post only)
2		6	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 24/07/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 11/08/2026 at 4:00 PM	Date & Time of Opening of Technical Bid - 29/08/2026 at 4:00 PM

All other terms and conditions of the RFP remain unchanged.

Joint Secretary to Govt. & SPD, PM-USHA
11001/245/2627
OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0037

DEATH ANNIVERSARIES

FOURTH YEAR REMEMBRANCE


SMT. SARASWATHI PITCHUMANI (RETD. DCE/CHENNAI)
09/10/1951 - 04/08/2022
Remembering you every moment with lots of love in our hearts. Husband/Sons/Daughters-in-law and Grand son
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CMYK

HC grants bail to 9 accused of attacking ED officials

The Hindu Bureau
KOCHI

The Kerala High Court has allowed the bail petitions of nine accused in the attack on Enforcement Directorate (ED) officials during a raid on former Chief Minister Pinarayi Vijayan's residence in May. Justice Kausar Edappagath granted bail to the accused, reasoning that they had been in remand for more than 60 days and that they had no criminal history.

The court noted that, according to the case diary, the accusation against the petitioners was very serious and it showed a pre-meditated criminal act. However, the investigation was in its final stage, with fingerprints of the 25 accused sent for analysis.

Rain toll rises to 18 in Kerala; over 13,000 in relief camps across State

CM Satheesan says the situation in most districts is now under control following a decline in rainfall; urges residents in vulnerable locations to relocate immediately; announces rehabilitation package; ₹8 lakh to be given to families of deceased

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Heavy showers continued to batter parts of Kerala for the third consecutive day on Monday, taking the death toll to 18, despite a considerable reduction in the intensity of rain.

Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan, who chaired an emergency meeting on Monday morning to review the flood situation, said the situation in most districts was now under control following a decline in rainfall. However, 18 people have lost their lives in rain-related incidents, while three others remain missing, according to official figures.



Residents of Kannadikkal vacating their houses after water levels in the Poonoor River in Kozhikode rose on Monday. K. RAGESH

A total of 13,496 people are currently sheltering in 363 relief camps across the State.

Addressing a press conference after a review meeting, the Chief Minister said teams of the Fire and

Rescue Services and the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF) had been deployed in the worst-affected areas, including Pathanamthitta and Kottayam, to carry out rescue operations.

Preparations have been completed to air-drop food packets to people stranded in isolated areas. Mr. Satheesan urged residents in vulnerable locations to relocate immediately as instructed by authorities.

The government has announced a total compensation of ₹8 lakh for families of the deceased, with an immediate assistance of ₹10,000 to meet funeral expenses. Families returning from relief camps will be provided ₹10,000 to clean their houses. For a ration card-holding family that lost its livelihood, ₹300 each will be provided to two members until normalcy returns. As part of the rehabilitation package,

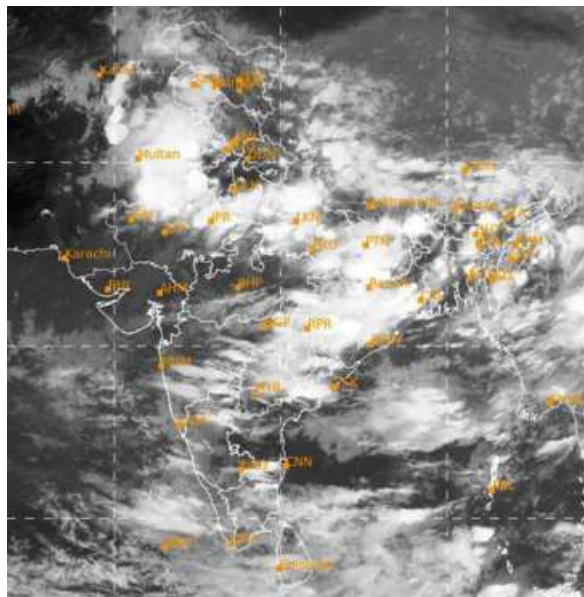
assistance for purchasing land and constructing a house has been increased from ₹10 lakh to ₹12 lakh, while compensation for those who have lost their houses has been raised from ₹4 lakh to ₹6 lakh.

Mr. Satheesan said the flooding was triggered by extremely heavy rainfall, with some places recording over 350 mm of rain. He clarified that no major dams had been opened because of the heavy rainfall. Only smaller dams with comparatively lower storage capacity, such as Moozhaiyar, had released water.

The India Meteorological department (IMD) issued an orange alert for 12 districts for Tuesday.

WEATHERWATCH

Rainfall, temperature & air quality in select metros yesterday



TEMPERATURE DATA: IMD, POLLUTION DATA: CPCB, MAP: INSAT/IMD (TAKEN AT 18.15 HRS)

Forecast for Tuesday: Heavy/very heavy rainfall likely at isolated places over Jammu & Kashmir, Ladakh, Himachal Pradesh, Delhi, Uttarakhand, Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, Assam, Meghalaya, Nagaland, Manipur, Mizoram, Tripura, Sikkim, West Bengal, Jharkhand, Odisha, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Kerala and Andaman & Nicobar Islands

CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN	CITY	RAIN	MAX	MIN
Agartala	1.....	34.4.....	26.1.....	Kurnool		35.6.....	25.9.....
Ahmedabad	0.2.....	33.5.....	26.6.....	Lucknow		34.2.....	33.9.....
Aizawl	0.3.....	31.6.....	23.8.....	Madurai		38.0.....	27.1.....
Bengaluru	1.5.....	28.3.....	22.0.....	Mangaluru		24.6.....	28.0.....
Bhopal		30.5.....	24.0.....	Mumbai		48.....	30.8.....
Bhubaneswar	38.....	34.6.....	26.0.....	Mysuru		29.8.....	21.0.....
Chandigarh		35.2.....	26.2.....	New Delhi		35.6.....	28.4.....
Chennai		36.6.....	26.7.....	Patna		1.6.....	30.0.....
Coimbatore		31.6.....	22.4.....	Port Blair		12.....	30.5.....
Dehradun	0.7.....	29.5.....	24.9.....	Prayagraj		63.....	34.0.....
Gangtok	16.....	23.9.....	18.6.....	Puducherry		0.1.....	38.0.....
Goa		52.....	30.5.....	Pune		4.6.....	28.1.....
Guwahati		33.9.....	27.5.....	Raipur		34.0.....	27.0.....
Hubballi		28.0.....	22.0.....	Ranchi		15.....	29.2.....
Hyderabad	0.6.....	31.9.....	24.3.....	Shillong		15.....	26.4.....
Imphal		32.3.....	27.5.....	Shimla		25.4.....	20.8.....
Jaipur		31.2.....	27.0.....	Srinagar		3.6.....	32.2.....
Kochi	57.....	29.6.....	23.2.....	Thiruvananthapuram		17.8.....	31.0.....
Kohima		25.0.....	20.0.....	Thiruchirappalli		38.1.....	28.0.....
Kolkata	16.....	35.5.....	28.2.....	Vijayawada		9.....	35.2.....
Kozhikode	33.....	27.8.....	24.7.....	Visakhapatnam		34.4.....	28.0.....

Pollutants in the air you are breathing							Yesterday
CITIES	SO ₂	NO ₂	CO	PM _{2.5}	PM ₁₀	CODE	
Ahmedabad	3.....	9.....	135.....	54.....	65.....		In observation made at 4.00 p.m., Bihar Sharif, Bihar recorded an overall air quality index (AQI) score of 387 indicating an unhealthy level of pollution. In contrast, Naharlagun, Arunachal Pradesh recorded a healthy AQI score of 13
Bengaluru	20.....	27.....	49.....	28.....	63.....		
Chennai		4.....	8.....	35.....	12.....	167.....	
Delhi		16.....	27.....	66.....	128.....	125.....	
Hyderabad		13.....	13.....	31.....	46.....	69.....	
Kolkata		19.....	23.....	53.....	91.....	106.....	
Lucknow		35.....	12.....	24.....	56.....	116.....	
Mumbai		6.....	5.....	40.....	47.....	92.....	
Pune		10.....	20.....	64.....	32.....	50.....	
Visakhapatnam		8.....	67.....	12.....	69.....	130.....	

Air Quality Code: ■ Poor ■ Moderate ■ Good (Readings indicate average AQI)

SO₂: Sulphur Dioxide. Short-term exposure can harm the respiratory system, making breathing difficult. It can affect visibility by reacting with other air particles to form haze and stain culturally important objects such as statues and monuments.

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Karnataka Cabinet expanded amid protests, rebellion

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The D.K. Shivakumar-led Congress government in Karnataka on Monday expanded the Cabinet inducting 19 legislators, two months after he was sworn in along with 13 Ministers. While eight of the new Ministers are first-timers, six from the former Chief Minister Siddaramaiah's Cabinet have been retained.

Though the name of A.V. Gayatri Shanthegowda figured in the initial list of legislators, ultimately, she was not sworn in. The Cabinet does not have representation for women.

Given the lobbying by over 50 Cabinet hopefuls over the last two months, it was expected that at least two Cabinet berths could

be kept vacant. The party initially decided to fill up the entire Cabinet quota of 34, but eventually kept one berth vacant after pressure mounted. The list was modified hours before the swearing in.

The party has also named its candidates for the posts of Speaker and Deputy Speaker in the Legislative Assembly and Chairman and Deputy Chairman in the Legislative Council.

B. Nagendra, who had resigned from former Chief Minister Siddaramaiah's Cabinet after his name surfaced in the multi-crore financial scam in Valmiki Development Corporation and later arrested, has made a comeback.

The Cabinet expansion has triggered widespread



Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar (left), and Governor Thaaawarchand Gehlot (centre) at the oath-taking ceremony. ANI

discontent in the ruling Congress.

MLA resigns

The immediate flashpoint was the resignation of three-time Indi MLA Yashwanthrayagouda Patil, who submitted his resignation from the Assembly membership after being overlooked for a Cabinet berth. MLA for Sagar Belur Gopalakrishna also announced that he would re-

nounce on Tuesday, escalating what began as behind-the-scenes lobbying into open dissent and increasing pressure on Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar and the Congress high command.

Several senior legislators openly expressed disappointment over their exclusion. Some of them said they would consult their supporters before deciding

on their future course of action.

Several MLAs alleged that the party leadership had given preference to legislators who had joined the Congress from other parties over loyalists.

"We will create one or the other opportunity and legislators have to remain patient," the Chief Minister said, appealing to the legislators.

The anger quickly spilled onto the streets, with supporters staging protests outside Legislators' Home in Bengaluru, burning tyres in some constituencies and raising slogans against the party leadership.

The Cabinet composition has also drawn criticism over regional and community representation.

While no woman or Brahmin MLA has found a place, no representation has been given to Kolar and Chickballapur districts.

Political functionaries observed that last-minute changes to the Cabinet list reflected differences among Mr. Shivakumar, former Chief Minister Siddaramaiah, and the Congress high command.

Apparently irked over the list of Ministers, Mr. Siddaramaiah did not attend the swearing-in ceremony at Lok Bhavan.

Seeking to contain the rebellion, Mr. Shivakumar appealed to disappointed legislators to remain patient, recalling that he himself had not found a place in the initial Cabinet formations in 2004 and 2013.

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3. Period downloading of Bidding Documents:-Date 07.08.2026 to 27.08.2026 Time 4.00 P.M.
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I, **ANUSH** Bakia s/o Nagaragen born on 13-12-2001 residing at 3 Muthu ST Santhome Ch-4, have changed my name to Anush Bakia Nagaragen vide affidavit dated 1-8-26 at Chennai

PERSONAL

I, **SANKARI** Debnath dependent of Tanmay Debnath residing at SMQ No. 08/03, DO 1, Air Force Station Avadi, Avadi IAF post, Chennai-600055 have changed my name to Shankari Debnath vide affidavit dated 16 Jul 26 at Avadi, Chennai.

I, **MOHAMED** Asad N (also known as Mohamed Asad), s/o Naseem Ahmed, born on 12/03/2001, residing at No.13, Mosque Street, Kilpauk Garden Road, Chennai, Tamil Nadu – 600010, have changed my name to Muhammad Asad Ahmed vide affidavit dated 01/08/2026 at Chennai.

I, **MOSLEMA** Bibi m/o Mostafijur Molah, resident of Singhaluli, Samudragarh, Purba Bardhaman, WB, 713519 have changed my name from Moslema Bibi to Moslema Bibi Molla vide Affidavit 5769 dated 23/02/2026 before Notary, Sri Vijaya Purnam

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Any person/s is/are having knowledge or possession of aforesaid Original Document/s shall inform or lodge their claim or charge/s if any, to undermentioned address within 15 DAYS from today, failing which it would be deemed and concluded that the Documents are not traceable/available as such and no further claim/possession or create an interest either over the said Documents or property by anyone and subsequent claim will not be entertained and the same will not be binding on my client.

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PUBLIC NOTICE

NOTICE

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[Pursuant to section 374(b) of the Companies Act, 2013 and rule 4(I) of the Companies (Authorised to Register) Rules, 2014]

1. Notice is hereby given that in pursuance of sub-section (2) of section 366 of the Companies Act, 2013, an application is proposed to be made after fifteen days hereof but before the expiry of thirty days hereinafter to the Registrar at Chennai that YUBEI STAY SERVICES LLP (LLPIN AAW-9996) a LLP may be registered under Part I of Chapter XXI of the Companies Act 2013, as a company limited by shares.

2.The principal objects of the company are as follows: To carry on the business of providing property management services to those clients who provide rental /lease/ license accommodation to working professionals, students, senior citizens, industrial workers, and all other people at affordable cost.

3. A copy of the draft Memorandum and Articles of association of the proposed company may be inspected at the Registered Office of the LLP at Shop No. 1/529, Pillayar Koil Street, Thuraiyakkam, Chennai 600097 during business hours on any working day.

4. Notice is hereby given that any person objecting to this application may communicate their objection in writing to the ROC CRC, IICA, Manesar, Plot No. 6, 7 & 8, sector-5, IMT Manesar, Gurgaon, Haryana – 122050, within twenty one days from the date of publication of this notice, with a copy to the company at its registered office of the LLP.

Dated this 04th day of August 2026
For Yubei Stay Services
Jai Ganesh A
Designated Partner

For Yubei Stay Services LLP
Sathishkumar M
Designated Partner

ENGAGEMENTS

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A TIMELESS EVENING OF BLACK & WHITE HINDI MELODIES ENTHRALS CHENNAI

On July 26, 2026, Music lovers in Chennai were treated to an unforgettable evening of nostalgia as Mrs. Usha Sampath Kumar's sensational singing ensemble, Xpressions, presented a spectacular concert of evergreen black-and-white Hindi film songs at the Spastic Society Hall, Taramani, on Sunday. True to the theme of the evening, every singer graced the stage dressed elegantly in black and white, creating a striking visual harmony that perfectly complemented the timeless classics they performed. The beautifully decorated stage, warm ambience, and the enthusiasm of a packed audience transformed the venue into a celebration of the golden era of Hindi cinema. The programme featured a carefully curated collection of immortal melodies that have stood the test of time. Each rendition was delivered with remarkable finesse, emotion, and authenticity, transporting the audience back to an era when melody reigned supreme. The singers captivated listeners with their expressive voices, flawless presentation, and heartfelt performances. Mrs. Usha Sampath Kumar deserves special appreciation for conceptualising and presenting such a unique musical experience. Under her guidance, the talented members of Xpressions showcased exceptional teamwork, dedication, and passion, making the evening a resounding success. The live orchestra added richness and depth to every performance, recreating the magic of the original compositions while allowing the singers to shine. The seamless coordination between the musicians and vocalists ensured that every number resonated beautifully with the audience. By the end of the concert, the standing ovation from the audience spoke louder than words. The evening was not merely a musical programme but a heartfelt tribute to the legendary composers, lyricists, and playback singers whose timeless creations continue to touch generations. Not forgetting to thank the Orchestra of Sujit and team who rocked the show with their live band. The Xpressions concert proved once again that great music never fades. It transcends time, evokes cherished memories, and brings people together through the universal language of melody. For everyone present at the Spastic Society Hall on July 26, this black-and-white musical extravaganza will remain a cherished memory for years to come.



The undermining of institutional opposition

Now that the Gen Z revolutionaries have exited Jantar Mantar, the analysts and strategists at the Prime Minister’s Office must be taking stock. For starters, Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s team got at least one decision right – the decision to get former Union Minister Dharmendra Pradhan to resign just in time. Any further delay would most likely have become a point of no return for the National Democratic Alliance (NDA) government. Demonstrations were occurring at the district level and a critical momentum was building across the nation with Bihar, the ground zero of unemployment, fast turning violent.

But apart from Mr. Pradhan’s timely resignation, all the other interventions of the Government of India as a response to the Cockroach Janta Party’s (CJP) movement was a mix between the ridiculous and the laughable. It is clear as daylight that the Prime Minister’s team singularly failed to grasp who and what they were actually dealing with.

Brewing anger

The starting assumption of the government was that it was confronting a rag-tag collection of middle-class youth whose sense of politics was immature and lacking in stamina for any mass movement to emerge. The overwhelming official common sense was to let the CJP movement simply fizzle out in the monsoon heat and humidity. Part of the misreading involved keeping the CJP leaders waiting at Union Health Minister J.P Nadda’s residence for over two hours, while the government simultaneously set up plans to cut a deal with Sonam Wangchuk alongside operationalising a brutal lathi charge on the Gen Z campaigners on July 20.

To the government’s evident surprise, however, by July 20 evening, there was a massive turnaround in both the quality and quantity of the resistance. Not



Rajesh Mahapatra

Independent journalist and former editor of the Press Trust of India



Rohan D’Souza

Professor at Graduate School of Asian and African Area Studies, Kyoto University, Japan

The extreme centralisation of power has been steadily undermining the resilience within Indian political institutions

only did the CJP survive the brutal lathi charge and tear gas shelling, the campaign now took on the flavour of an all-India level ‘revolt’ of the people at large. An anti-Modi mood had become plainly discernible, with Instagram fired up with creative messaging and demonstrations by the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP)’s own taken-for-granted upper class and upper caste social base.

However, even at such a high-pressure moment, the best the Prime Minister’s team could manage was a late night badly sketched Instagram video by Mr. Modi himself. Poorly executed and full of misplaced messaging, it, unsurprisingly, only added fuel to the fire. And after the Prime Minister released another hapless reel the following day, the Government of India finally threw in the towel with Mr. Pradhan’s resignation.

There is no doubt that the CJP is every bit a rag-tag outfit that is organisationally inchoate. But what it nonetheless managed to effectively achieve was to quickly tap into and electrify a vast reservoir of resentment, anger, grievance and unhappiness amongst India’s economically much beleaguered middle class and aspirational poorer classes. By doing so, it managed to reveal the considerable fragility within the Indian political landscape. The extreme centralisation of power has, over the years, been steadily undermining the resilience within Indian political institutions. Consequently, the CJP by pitching its campaign as a resistance rather than within the rules of institutional Opposition politics was able to rattle the highest level of political authority.

Undermining democracy

At the heart of this crisis lies the Modi-Shah political playbook. For years, democratic politics with institutional safeguards have been systematically undermined in India. There is, in fact, the standard fix now for eliminating any opposition. The Modi-Shah

political playbook has mainstreamed the use of the Enforcement Directorate and the Central Bureau of Investigation; the wanton buying and selling of MPs and MLAs; and have been making courts pliable at the highest level. Additionally, the questionable manner in which the highly controversial Special Intensive Revision (SIR) is being implemented can also be added to this list. There is great fear that the election process will increasingly become a selection exercise for the government in power.

In such conditions, a single trigger event, such as the CJP movement, could spark an immediate existential threat to an existing political order. However, while credit should be given to the CJP for showing resolve, and for the ability to organise and direct a grievance peacefully, their strategy is located entirely outside the political terrain of institutional politics. Thus, although Mr. Pradhan’s resignation may appear to be a signature victory for them, it more ominously reveals the turbulence and fragility within India’s political institutions. There could be less control over the street in the days to come, unless the Modi-Shah playbook ends.

The CJP has revealed that India is perilously close to losing its ability to manage a peaceful democratic transition. Though Rahul Gandhi, the Congress party, and several other Opposition parties did manage to register a strong presence throughout the Jantar Mantar movement, their hold was still less than enough and far too tenuous.

Mr. Pradhan’s resignation should perhaps be more correctly seen as the first tremor within a Republic that is buckling from its weakening democratic foundations. If anything, the most important lesson to be taken from the CJP campaign is that the constant undermining of any legitimate opposition space by the Modi-Shah play book can, unless checked, result in social instability and political chaos.

The dilemma over PM SHRI in Kerala

The UDF is caught between the need for central funds and maintaining its integrity

STATE OF PLAY

Roshni R.K.

The much discussed PM SHRI (PM Schools for Rising India) scheme has the recently elected Congress-led United Democratic Front (UDF) government in Kerala in hot soup.

Events over the past few days seem to indicate that similar to the Pinarayi Vijayan-led Left Democratic Front (LDF) government that burnt its fingers after signing an MoU for implementing the centrally sponsored PM SHRI scheme in October last year, the UDF government too could be in for possible backlash if it decides to go ahead with it. It is deja vu all over again. The same issue. The same actors. Only the roles have reversed.

The UDF government led by Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan argued that it was forced to continue with the PM SHRI as the previous LDF government had already entered into an agreement with the Union government. The State badly needs the ₹1,158.13 crore in education funds being held up by the Centre. The volte-face could not have been more glaring, since Mr. Satheesan had earlier said that Mr. Vijayan, by inking the deal, had betrayed the national cause against the National Education Policy (NEP), 2020.

Wavering stance

A little over a month after forming the UDF government, Mr. Satheesan said that only the Union government had the right to withdraw from the MoU. Kerala became a party to it the moment the agreement was signed, an argument that the current Opposition vehemently denies.

In yet another U-turn, the



Chief Minister later denied that the government had said that it would implement the PM SHRI; UDF convener Adoor Prakash had said that the government would go ahead with the scheme, even as the report of a UDF Cabinet sub-committee on the PM SHRI was awaited. It prompted the Indian Union Muslim League (IUML) leader P.K. Kunhalikutty to assert that a final decision would be taken only after the sub-committee gave its report, exposing the fault lines within the UDF. Other Muslim organisations, such as the Samastha Kerala Jamiyathul Ulama, have also been vocal about their opposition.

These repeated flip-flops made it evident that the government was in a bind over how to balance fiscal prudence, coalition pressures, and its ideological position on the NEP.

Pros and cons

The Union Minister of State for Education Jayant Chaudhary once replied in the Rajya Sabha, “States that do not sign the MoU or withdraw from the scheme stand to miss out on these benefits of PM SHRI scheme”. It has to be remembered that Punjab had opted out of the scheme in 2023, but later went back on its decision after the Union government had frozen the funds.

On the other hand, there are concerns about the curriculum. The PM SHRI Schools

framework states that the curriculum should follow the National Curriculum Framework/State Curriculum Framework developed in accordance with new curricular structure of the NEP. The MoU, for its part, says that States should implement all the provisions of the NEP in its entirety. According to the NEP, States can prepare their own curricula and textbooks, incorporating the State’s demands as needed. However, it goes on to say, “while doing so, it must be borne in mind that the NCERT curriculum would be taken as the nationally acceptable criterion.” Last year, the former Minister for General Education V. Sivanikutty had pointed out that the Union government had declared in 2022 that the objective of the Samagra Shiksha scheme was to help implement the NEP.

Even if the Union government does not appear to be intervening in the curriculum of the States at present, there is apprehension that other interventions such as curriculum-based programme implementation or prescription of teaching-learning materials/assessment patterns could well be thrust upon them.

Other than taking the legal route like Tamil Nadu did, the UDF has the option of writing to the Union government insisting on the freedom to decide its own curriculum. This undoubtedly will expose it to harsh criticism of allowing the NEP to be smuggled into the State. However, if it chooses not to implement the PM SHRI, it will lose out on crucial federal funding.

Damned if they do and damned if they don’t – that is the UDF’s dilemma on the PM SHRI scheme.

roshni.r.k@thehindu.co.in

The problem with India’s free trade agreement strategy

India’s trade with key FTA partners such as the ASEAN countries has become increasingly import-driven, resulting in widening trade deficits

DATA POINT

Surendar Singh

Over the past few years, India has shown great interest in trade diplomacy to promote its economic and strategic interests. India’s new founded enthusiasm in external engagement has culminated in Free Trade Agreements (FTAs) with the UAE, Australia, Oman, the U.K., the European Union, and most recently, New Zealand. Its imperative to enhance market access continues to extend the reach of its trade architecture through ongoing trade talks with the U.S., Gulf countries and Canada, highlighting a decisive shift towards bilateralism as a vehicle of market access, value chain integration and economic dynamism. There is an emerging view among policymakers, trade diplomats, and geopolitical analysts that FTAs are indispensable instruments of economic statecraft. However, the enthusiasm on enhanced market access through trade agreements and Global Value Chain (GVC) integration is founded on a set of implicit assumptions and dominant narratives that continue to maintain a striking analytical silence. The argument that FTAs stimulate export growth and GVC integration warrants a far more nuanced view.

Widening trade deficit

India’s FTA experience with Asian economies has not been favourable. India’s trade with key FTA partners such as the Association of Southeast Asian Nations (ASEAN), South Korea, Japan and Singapore has become increasingly import-driven, resulting in widening trade deficits. Data shows that India’s trade deficit with ASEAN increased sharply from \$10.4 billion in 2012 to \$51.2 billion in 2025, driven by rapidly rising imports. In the same manner, imports increased at a much faster pace than exports in the case of Japan and South Korea.

India’s trade surplus has turned into a trade deficit in the case of Singapore after signing the trade agreement, exhibiting weakening export competitiveness.

India’s export performance across its major Asian FTA partners such as ASEAN, Japan, South Korea and Singapore reveals an intriguing picture – its underperformance. India’s share of the import basket among FTA partners has either stagnated or gradually eroded between 2012 to 2025, indicating a weakening in its export competitiveness post-FTAs. The most striking decline is in the case of ASEAN countries where India’s share of ASEAN’s import basket dropped from 3.42% to 1.71% while in the case of Singapore, the import share declined from 2.27% to 1.71%. Similarly, India’s share in South Korea’s import basket has declined from 1.33% to 1.02% while its share in Japan’s import basket shows mixed trends.

Collectively, these trends indicate that instead of leveraging trade agreements to integrate into regional production networks, India is stuck on the margins of manufacturing-led trade integration. The inability to capitalise on tariff preferences under the FTAs demonstrates that market access based on tariff elimination alone cannot compensate for weak domestic industrial capabilities, logistical inefficiencies, and infrastructure and operational constraints. India’s trade challenge is not fundamentally about negotiating more FTAs but about strengthening domestic productive capabilities and associated impediments. Without adequate industrial transformation, FTAs risk becoming instruments that increase import penetration faster than export competitiveness, thereby widening asymmetrical trade outcomes and structural vulnerabilities.

Moreover, FTAs are often presented as GVC drivers, eliminating barriers to the development of shared production arrangements and industrial upgrading. It is in-

teresting to note that India’s GVC integration related to trade as a percentage of gross trade declined from 37.13% to 34.38%, indicating that India’s integration in GVC networks has actually weakened. India’s GVC trade as a share of gross trade with its FTA partners has declined in the case of South Korea, Japan, Indonesia, Thailand, Vietnam, and Cambodia. Only in the case of Malaysia, Singapore and Philippines, has it increased.

These trends demonstrate that India’s FTAs have not translated into broad-based GVC integration. This evidence challenges the conventional assumption that FTAs automatically foster GVC integration through trade liberalisation. Moreover, it raises questions about the proposition that deeper commitments to market access and regulatory harmonisation are, in themselves, sufficient to promote GVC participation. The contemporary policy narrative surrounding India’s new FTAs and their ability to integrate into GVCs raises some critical questions.

An assessment

The declining export shares and weakening GVC integration in the case of India’s key FTA partners clearly highlight the limitations of considering FTAs primarily as instruments of market access. It is understandable that FTAs may enhance market access in certain product categories, but their abilities to foster productive capabilities is still contested. This essentially means that India’s FTA strategy needs to move beyond the standard argument of market access. It should focus on greater interaction with the broader industrial policy framework that emphasises technological upgrading, strategic investment, supply chain realignment, domestic value addition and domestic reforms. Without such policies, FTAs are likely to remain instruments of trade liberalisation that constrain policy flexibilities rather than drivers of industrial transformation.

Are the FTAs working?

The data for the charts were sourced from the International Trade Centre - Trade Map



Piyush Goyal, S. Jaishankar, European Council President Antonio Costa, and other officials at the India-EU FTA meeting in Brussels on July 15

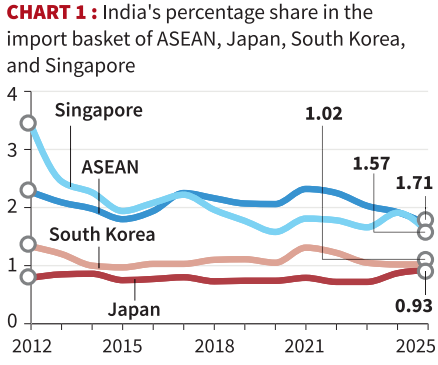


TABLE 1: India’s trade with key FTA partners (in \$ billions)

Partner	Indicator	2012	2015	2018	2021	2024	2025
ASEAN	Export	32.3	26.35	36.25	40.68	42.71	35.96
	Import	42.74	41.47	57.51	64.84	81.87	87.19
	Trade balance	-10.44	-15.12	-21.26	-24.16	-39.16	-51.23
Japan	Export	6.4	4.5	4.8	6.1	5.8	6.1
	Import	12.4	9.6	12.6	14.4	18.9	20.9
	Trade balance	-5.95	-5.17	-7.83	-8.34	-13.06	-14.77
South Korea	Export	4.1	3.6	4.8	7.1	6	6
	Import	13.7	13.1	16.4	17.1	20.9	21.1
	Trade balance	-9.6	-9.48	-11.62	-9.97	-14.98	-15.12
Singapore	Export	13.6	7.8	10.5	10.7	15.7	10.7
	Import	7.8	7.4	14.5	18.2	20.5	23.7
	Trade balance	5.76	0.4	-3.99	-7.55	-4.87	-12.97

TABLE 2: India’s global value chain-related trade as a share of gross trade with Asian FTA partners

	2012	2020	GVC integration (Increase/Decrease)
Indonesia	41.77	30.1	-11.67
Japan	41.07	28.44	-12.63
Malaysia	49.92	50.26	0.34
South Korea	63.18	41.58	-21.6
Thailand	48.32	47.65	-0.67
Singapore	66.87	69.54	2.67
Philippines	30.47	33.9	3.43
Vietnam	56.89	54.57	-2.32
Cambodia	47.43	44.34	-3.09

The author is an Associate Professor at Jindal School of Liberal Arts and Humanities, O.P Jindal Global University, Sonapat. Views are personal

The declining share of GVC-related trade in total trade with several major FTA partners shows that preferential market access has been inadequate to bolster India’s participation in global production networks. This evidence challenges the conventional assumption that FTAs automatically foster GVC integration through trade liberalisation

FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO AUGUST 4, 1976

Goat breeding: new strategy

New Delhi, August 3: An ambitious scheme has been taken up to step up the production of Pashmina and Mohair, used in the manufacture of warm luxury fabrics which have a good export market.

The scheme is part of an all-India co-ordinated research project on goat breeding being implemented by the Indian Council of Agricultural Research (ICAR).

A multi-pronged strategy to improve Pashmina production includes selective breeding of indigenous goats and cross breeding with imported Soviet breeds. Efforts would also be made to rear them in the high altitude Himalayan regions of U.P. where these goats can thrive.

There are at present two research centres for improving Pashmina production located at Leh in Ladakh and Mukteswar in U.P.

According to the chief co-ordinator of the project, Dr. R. M. Acharya, there are at present only 40,000 Pashmina goats of Chan Thangi breed in Ladakh region and some small number in Himachal Pradesh.

These goats produce Pashmina of quality which is “as good or slightly better” than any produced in other countries.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO AUGUST 4, 1926

Schoolboys’ empire tour

Rugby, August 4: A party of forty public and secondary schoolboys left London to-day for Australia. They travel under the auspices of School Empire Tour Committee and will spend the remainder of the year touring Australia. Before the train left a letter was read from the Prince of Wales, which said, “Such tours are admirable from an education view point. My own experience tells me how much there is to learn from seeing other parts of the world and there is no adequate substitute for the real knowledge to be gained in this way. More especially do I welcome the idea of tours for schoolboys to Dominions from Imperial view point. Boys will, on this occasion, be in the position of representatives. I am confident they will see to it that those who meet them in Australia will judge well of them and through them of the country of schools which they represent.”

From Page One

T.N. moves SC over Cauvery water release

The State said the CWMA had reviewed the hydro-meteorological condition in Cauvery basin on July 30 and endorsed the July 28 recommendations of the Cauvery Water Regulations Committee (CWRC) to release waters from Krishnaraja Sagara and Kabini reservoirs at the rate of 3,500 cusecs from July 29 for 15 days.

“If the inflows into the 4 major reservoirs of Karnataka against 30 years average up to August 3, 2026 is considered, the pro-rata ratio works out to 46.34%. Based on this pro-rata ratio, the flows due from June 1, 2026 to August 12, 2026 works out to 26.95 tmc ft. The direction given by the CWRC and CWMA is only 4.536 tmc ft, which is far less than the quantum of water as per distress proportion,” the Tamil Nadu application said.

“Thus, it is evident that Karnataka has willfully not complied with the directions of CWRC/ CWMA. It is stated that as on August 3, Karnataka is having 23.078 tmc ft in KRS, 18.610 tmc ft in Kabini, 7.827 TMC in Harangi and 28.022 tmc ft in Hemavathy, totally 77.537 tmc ft of gross storage... Thus, Karnataka in spite of having adequate storage has failed to comply with the directions of CWMA,” Tamil Nadu contended.

Kishor breaches BJP’s fortress in Bankipur

A JSP worker, celebrating the victory while dancing to Bhojpuri songs, said: “Bankipur is just a trailer; the whole of Bihar is still to come.”

After the 22nd round of counting, when Mr. Kishor was leading by a margin of around 13,000 votes, he and his wife Jahanvi Das walked to the counting centre at A.N. College to join the party workers and supporters in celebrations.

“The people have not only elected an MLA, but the people of Bankipur have given a message to the central leadership of the BJP to replace Samrat Choudhary with a better person,” Mr. Kishor said.

He added that the time had come for Prime Minister Narendra Modi to not only care about the people of Gujarat but also pay attention to the people of Bihar. “My only concern is that the young people of Bihar need to go to other States in search of jobs. Migration should be stopped from Bihar,” he said.

In Gujarat, the BJP retained the Manjalpur Assembly seat in Vadodara district, with its candidate Satish Govindbhai Patel defeating Congress nominee and former Minister Bhikhabhai Rabari by 30,630 votes in the July 30 byelection.

The Congress defended Madhya Pradesh’s Datia Assembly constituency, with its candidate Ghanshyam Singh claiming victory over the BJP’s Ashutosh Tiwari by 6,016 votes.

Ex-WFI chief cleared in sexual harassment case

Former Olympian Vinesh Phogat alleged that Mr. Singh had used his influence to pressure several complainants into withdrawing their names, while others continued to pursue the case in court. “We have not lost hope, and the wrestlers will continue their fight,” she said.

Mr. Singh said, “What I had said in the beginning has proved to be true. I did not know why people made all those allegations against me. My first reaction was that if the allegations were found to be true, I would hang myself. Today, the court has honourably acquitted me. It is a matter of great happiness for me and my supporters. Today is a day of joy.”

Women wrestlers, including Sakshi Malik, Ms. Vinesh, Bajrang Punia and Sangeeta Phogat, had staged protests in New Delhi for several months in 2023, demanding the arrest of the BJP leader over allegations that he had sexually harassed several women wrestlers, including a minor. The complainants had alleged that the incidents took place between 2016 and 2019 at the WFI office, Mr. Singh’s official residence, and during overseas tours.

Consider plea against Jantar Mantar use: SC

“Today, digitally mobilised movements can transform a few hundred persons into several thousand within hours, without a reliable command structure, verified organisers or an enforceable estimate of attendance. Jantar Mantar’s proximity to Parliament, Central Vista, government establishments, and diplomatic and commercial areas creates an avoidable convergence of mass mobilisation, national-security sensitivity, and restricted physical space,” the counsel submitted.

Ordinary people were finding it extremely hard to commute in central Delhi due to prolonged traffic snarls caused by protests and demonstrations, the petitioner said. Mr. Kaushik’s side referred to Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) national convener Arvind Kejriwal’s national townhall programme held outside the Constitution Club to protest the implementation of the E20 ethanol blended fuel policy.

In 2018, the Supreme Court had held that the golden rule was the right to protest should be balanced with the right of residents to live peacefully. The observation had come in a decision lifting the ban on protests at Jantar Mantar and Boat Club.

Lok Sabha passes SC judges Bill without any discussion

Lower House clears legislation to increase strength of judges in the top court from 34 to 38 amid protests by the Opposition; Bankers’ Books Evidence Bill, Indian Statistical Institute Bill introduced

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Lok Sabha on Monday passed a Bill to increase the sanctioned strength of judges in the Supreme Court without any discussion as persistent protests by Opposition members over the police action against protesting students at Jantar Mantar and the alleged *chadhawa chori* (theft of offerings) at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya continued to disrupt proceedings.

Two other Bills – the Bankers’ Books Evidence Bill, 2026, and the Indian Statistical Institute Bill, 2026 – were introduced amid sloganeering in the afternoon.

Repeated adjournments

The House was adjourned repeatedly during the day as Opposition members trooped into the Well raising slogans and displaying placards, forcing Speaker Om Birla to suspend proceedings first till noon, then till 2 p.m., before adjourning the House for the day following the passage of the Supreme Court



The House saw repeated adjournments amid Opposition protests and sloganeering in the Monsoon Session. ANI

(Number of Judges) Amendment Bill, 2026.

At the Business Advisory Committee (BAC) meeting, sources told *The Hindu* that Congress deputy leader Gaurav Gogoi, chief whip Kodikunnil Suresh and Samajwadi Party MP Dharmendra Yadav demanded that Home Minister Amit Shah make a statement in the House on the police crackdown on protesters and that the government initiate a discussion on the alleged embezzlement of funds at the Ram Temple, during which Prime Minister Narendra Modi could intervene.

The BAC allotted three hours each for discussion on the Bankers’ Books Evidence Bill and the Indian Statistical Institute Bill, and five hours for the Taxation and Other Laws (Amendment) Bill. However, there was no discussion on taking up the proposed amendments to the Foreign Contribution (Regulation) Act (FCRA).

Judges Bill

The Supreme Court (Number of Judges) Amendment Bill replaces an ordinance promulgated earlier this year to raise the sanctioned strength of the apex

court from 34 to 38 judges, including the Chief Justice of India. A statutory resolution moved by Opposition members seeking disapproval of the ordinance was rejected by voice vote.

Union Law Minister Arjun Ram Meghwal briefly introduced the Bill, but with protests continuing, it was passed by voice vote without debate. The government has argued that increasing the court’s strength is essential to address mounting pendency.

Amid the disruptions, the House also introduced the Indian Statistical Institute Bill and the Bankers’ Books Evidence Bill. The Indian Statistical Institute Bill seeks to repeal the 1959 Act governing the institution and incorporate it as a statutory body corporate with the President as its Visitor and a Board of Governors as its principal executive body.

The Bankers’ Books Evidence Bill, introduced by Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman, seeks to replace the 1891 law by recognising electronic, digital, virtual and cloud-based banking records as admissible evidence in courts.

Rajya Sabha passes Bill on MSMEs amid Opposition protests

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Amid the Opposition’s uproar demanding an apology from Union Home Minister Amit Shah over the police action against protesting youth and students, the Rajya Sabha on Monday passed the Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises Development (Amendment) Bill, 2026. The Upper House functioned for only 19 minutes in the morning, and after reconvening in the afternoon, was adjourned for the day soon after the Bill was passed.

Opposition members did not participate in the discussion on the Bill. Amendments moved by INDIA bloc members Ajay Maken, John Brittas, V. Sivadasan and A.A. Rahim were defeated by a voice vote.

The Bill, which replaces the 2006 Act, provides for the notification of a national digital platform for the free and voluntary registration of micro, small and medium enterprises (MSMEs). According to Union MSME Minister Jitan Ram Manjhi, the legislation seeks to address the sector’s liquidity concerns by mandating all Central Public Sector Enterprises

Union MSME Minister Jitan Ram Manjhi says the draft legislation seeks to address the sector’s liquidity concerns

(CPSEs) to route invoice settlements through the Trade Receivables Discounting System (TReDS) for the procurement of goods and services from MSMEs.

Replying to the debate, Mr. Manjhi said the Narendra Modi government had extended strong support to the MSME sector and remained committed to its growth. He appealed to the Opposition to support the legislation, saying, “The objective is to balance the interests of all concerned parties while maintaining constitutional principles and the interests of businesses.”

Highlighting the sector’s contribution to the economy, Mr. Manjhi said MSMEs contribute 31% to India’s GDP, 36% to the country’s manufacturing output and 41% to exports. He also said outstanding credit disbursed to MSMEs had risen to more than ₹38.35 lakh crore from ₹10 lakh crore in 2014-15.

Pappu Yadav’s Parliament skit ‘incorrect act’, says SP

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

The Samajwadi Party (SP) has expressed displeasure over Independent MP Pappu Yadav’s playacting as a saffron-clad seer in an impromptu skit staged by INDIA bloc members in Parliament on Friday. The skit has drawn criticism from the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) also and led to police complaints against Opposition leaders.

According to sources, at the meeting held at the office of Leader of the Opposition in the Rajya Sabha Mallikarjun Kharge in Parliament, SP leader Dharmendra Yadav raised the issue. He expressed concern that the skit was a misstep in what has so far been a successful campaign highlighting the alleged corruption in the Ram Temple donation scam. Such acts, he argued, risked being seen as mocking devotees and could backfire.

Sources said Mr. Pappu Yadav came dressed in saffron and brought Lord Ram’s photograph without consulting the other leaders. The skit was not pre-



Pappu Yadav

planned and was enacted on the spur of the moment.

Samajwadi Party leader Ramgopal Yadav spoke to presspersons on the issue. “It was wrong because the saints had nothing to do with the theft that took place in the Ram Temple. It was basically an incorrect act and it should not have happened,” he said.

Congress’s silence

Mr. Ramgopal said the Opposition would continue to raise the Ram Temple donations case because it concerns crores of people in India and abroad who contributed for the construction of the temple.

Speaking to presspersons, Mr. Dharmendra said

the BJP was trying to “dilute and deflect” attention from the Ram Temple donation scam by focusing on the Opposition protest.

“If a police case is being filed against Pappu Yadav, then why not one against BJP’s national president Nitin Nabin, who made Hanumanji dance in front of him,” he asked.

Mr. Dharmendra was referring to a procession organised by the BJP in Lucknow last month to welcome Mr. Nabin, during which a performer dressed as Lord Hanuman and carrying a party flag danced in front of the chariot carrying the BJP leader.

The Congress maintained a studied silence, refusing to engage with criticism of the skit.

Mr. Pappu defended his actions, accusing the government of double standards. “You can abuse Nehru, Indira Gandhi, or Mulayam Singh in the House. But when someone protests in a dignified manner outside the House, where does the question of ‘privilege’ arise? I will certainly present my case to the Speaker. I have also written a letter,” he said.

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

Opposition parties on Monday continued to protest in the Parliament House complex against the alleged donation theft at the Ram Temple in Ayodhya and police crackdown on the NEET examination paper leak demonstrations on July 20 in New Delhi.

Like last week, the MPs kept donation boxes near the Parliament entrance, *Makar Dwar*, to symbolise the alleged theft of donations at the temple and lined up around them to raise slogans against the government. Some MPs put cash in the box enacting the donations made and the “theft” that took place later.

Members of the Samajwadi Party who were present said till now more than ₹47,000 has been collected and the money would be donated to the Ram Temple at Ayodhya and a receipt would be taken.

Amit Shah’s absence

The Opposition MPs also protested against the “absence” of Union Home Mi-



Anand Bhadauriya, Dimple Yadav, Dharmendra Yadav, and other Opposition members stage a protest outside Parliament. ANI

nister Amit Shah from both Houses of Parliament.

The protesting MPs lined up behind a big banner that read “Why Amit Shah is absent from Parliament?” and raised slogans against Mr. Shah on the use of force against student protesters at the NEET examination paper leak agitation.

Priyanka Gandhi of the Congress, Dimple Yadav and Dharmendra Yadav of the SP, Mahua Moitra of the Trinamool Congress, Mahua Maji of the Jarkhand Mukti Morcha, and N.K. Premchandran of the Revolutionary Socialist Party were among those seen at the protest.

“Modiji is intimidating

and threatening the children. They do not come to the House, they do not answer questions, they do not speak on the theft of donations for Shri Ram Mandir, nor do they say anything on the suppression of students. Innocent children are not traitors, do not label them as such, the real traitors are the BJP people! who are crushing democracy,” Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge said.

Congress general secretary organisation K.C. Venugopal said: “Our protests outside Parliament, and on the floor of both Houses, will continue until the government is held accountable”.

Cauvery water issue: DMK members walk out from both Houses in protest

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) MPs on Monday staged a walkout from both Houses of Parliament protesting against Tamil Nadu being denied its share of Cauvery water. They also held a protest outside Parliament on the issue.

The protest is centred on the alleged violation of the Cauvery Water Management Authority’s directives, which dictate that Tamil Nadu should receive



P. Wilson

9.9 tmc ft of water in June and 32 tmc ft in July, bringing the total to 42 tmc ft. However, the State has

“not received a single drop” thus far in 2026.

The Tamil Nadu government has also approached the Supreme Court on the issue.

Plea for debate ignored

“The original demand of 7,000 cusecs based on the already existing backlog has to be released to us. We wanted the House to debate and pass a resolution on this,” Rajya Sabha member P. Wilson said.

DMK MPs carried placards in both Houses of Parliament. When their

plea for a debate was ignored, the DMK MPs staged a walk-out.

Mr. Wilson also blamed the Congress for ignoring the issue that he said affected nearly everyone in Tamil Nadu.

“The Congress is not bothered about the problems of Tamil Nadu. They are only talking about other issues, so we have brought to the attention of the Parliament that this issue has to be, you know, sorted out by the Union government,” the DMK MP said.

Justice M.S. Liberhan passes away at 87

Press Trust of India
CHANDIGARH

Justice Manmohan Singh Liberhan, who headed the commission that probed the circumstances leading to the demolition of the Babri mosque at Ayodhya, died at the age of 87 in Chandigarh on Sunday.

Justice Liberhan began his legal practice at the Punjab and Haryana High Court in 1964. He was elevated as a judge of the Punjab and Haryana High Court on February 11, 1987. He was appointed Chief Justice of the Madras High Court on July 7, 1997, and



Justice M.S. Liberhan

later became the Chief Justice of the Andhra Pradesh High Court on February 28, 1998. On December 16, 1992, Justice Liberhan was appointed head of the one-man inquiry commission into the Babri Masjid demolition.

For BJP, the result in Bankipur is more than just a poll defeat

A new cohort of Gen Z voters and discontent over centralised control of the State unit have contributed to BJP's loss in its stronghold in Bihar; abrupt replacement of the candidate without specifying a reason highlighted a sense of overconfidence

NEWS ANALYSIS

Nistula Hebbar
NEW DELHI

No Assembly bypoll has been watched with keener interest than the one that just concluded at Bankipur in Bihar in a resounding victory for Jan Suraj Party (JSP) leader Prashant Kishor.

He challenged the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) in a seat that is considered its stronghold since 1995 and was recently vacated by the party's national president Nitin Nabin. For the BJP, losing the Bankipur bypoll goes beyond the more typical loss of a stronghold to probing internal issues and factoring the electorate's changed demographic profile. The electoral loss comes on the heels of the Gen Z protests in the national capital.

In Bankipur, nearly a third of voters fall in the ur-



Reality check: PM Narendra Modi flanked by Union Minister Amit Shah and BJP national president Nitin Nabin in Parliament. PTI

ban Gen Z age group, the same cohort as the protesters at Jantar Mantar recently. These youngsters don't stand alone. Their parents, belonging to a different generation and possibly BJP supporters, have been affected just as much by shrinking opportunities for their children, and the police crackdown on the protests.

It did not help matters much when Mr. Nabin, the

former five-term Bankipur MLA, termed the Gen Z protesters as "virus[es] and cockroaches, a gang devoted to breaking the country".

Low voter turnout
The election saw a low turnout of around 34%, nearly seven percentage points lower than in the 2025 Assembly election. Clearly, many voters who had backed the BJP in 2025

either stayed home or voted for Mr. Kishor.

The BJP has had to wait for decades to have its own Chief Minister in Bihar. For years, despite being the party with a stronger organisation and a bigger social base, it needed the social engineering of Backward Classes from the non-Yadav Kurmi-Koeri communities that former Chief Minister and Janata Dal(U) supremo Nitish Kumar brought to the table.

In March, Mr. Kumar, said to be ailing, was finally persuaded to give way to the BJP's Samrat Choudhary as Chief Minister, and take up a seat in the Rajya Sabha. The selection of Mr. Choudhary, who joined the BJP after stints in the Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) and the JD(U), was not a popular move within the BJP's Bihar unit. They would have preferred a leader with a dyed-in-the-wool approach. But Mr. Choudhary too brought a

social base that the BJP wanted to keep. He was picked by the national leadership, with others expected to fall in line.

The BJP's confidence that its choice of Chief Minister had the backing of both the electorate and its local unit seems to have blinded it to the brewing discontent, especially after the death of social activist Bharat Tiwari, allegedly at the hands of Bihar Police. Mr. Kishor, in fact, kept revisiting this sore point among BJP cadre throughout his bypoll campaign.

This was followed by a change in the BJP's candidate, with the party replacing Abhishek Bunty with Neeraj Kumar Sinha for some unspecified issue. A remark attributed to a BJP leader during the campaign, later denied by the party, that anyone fielded by the BJP, even a dog or a cat, would be elected in Bankipur, highlighted the sense of hubris.

From steering campaigns to charting his own course

Amarnath Tewary
PATNA

Just a month ago, election strategist and Jan Suraj Party (JSP) founder Prashant Kishor announced that he would contest the Bankipur Assembly byelection in Patna.

"If the BJP wins the Bankipur election, I will have no hesitation in acknowledging that the people of Bihar endorse their policies, their public face, and their government. If the BJP loses, the government must accept that the people of Bihar do not approve its conduct, character, image, and system of governance," Mr. Kishor told the media while announcing his candidature.

The byelection marks Mr. Kishor's electoral debut. In the State election held in November 2025, the JSP couldn't win a single seat, though it contested in 238 out of the 243 Assembly constituencies.

Mr. Kishor was born on March 20, 1977, in Konar village in south-western Bihar's Rohtas district. He completed his schooling in



Prashant Kishor

Buxar in 1991 and then attended Patna Science College for intermediate studies. Later, he earned a Bachelor of Business Administration degree from Lucknow University, followed by advanced professional training and studies in public health and healthcare management.

He subsequently founded one of the country's largest political consultancy firms, the Indian Political Action Committee (I-PAC).

As a political strategist, Mr. Kishor worked for the BJP in Gujarat during the 2014 Lok Sabha election campaign, that saw the rise of Narendra Modi as a national leader. Following the 2014 Lok Sabha election, he and I-PAC parted ways with the BJP and worked

for Bihar's *Mahagathbandhan* – an alliance between the Janata Dal (United), the Rashtriya Janata Dal, and the Congress – in the 2015 Bihar Assembly election.

Mr. Kishor was subsequently appointed the vice-president of the JD(U). He and his firm later worked for several leading political parties, including the Congress, the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP), the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK), the Trinamool Congress, and the Yuvajana Sramika Rythu Congress Party (YSRCP).

The JD(U) left the Mahagathbandhan twice – in 2017 and 2022 – to join hands with the BJP. Mr. Kishor exited the Nitish Kumar-led party in 2020, citing differences over its support for the Citizenship Amendment Act (CAA).

In 2022, Mr. Kishor dissociated himself from I-PAC and launched the Jan Suraj Padyatra from Valmikinagar in Bihar's West Champaran district. He launched the Jan Suraj Party on October 2, 2024.

(With inputs from Nistula Hebbar)

In Datia, Congress kept a united front as BJP grappled with internal discord

Mehul Malpani
BHOPAL

Following a high-stakes byelection that witnessed a campaign involving several big faces and infighting rumours in both parties, the Congress on Monday retained Madhya Pradesh's Datia Assembly seat after defeating the ruling Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) candidate in the July 30 byelection.

In the results, Congress candidate Ghanshyam Singh defeated the BJP's Ashutosh Tiwari by 6,016 votes, while the Aazad Samaj Party's Damodar Yadav 'Mandal' finished third with 22,527 votes.

The bypoll was necessitated after the disqualification of the Congress's Rajendra Bharti in April following his conviction in a bank fraud case. Bharti had won the seat in 2023 Assembly election after defeating former State Home Minister and BJP heavy-weight Narottam Mishra,



On cloud nine: Congress workers in Bhopal celebrate Ghanshyam Singh's win in Datia Assembly byelection on Monday. A.M.FARUQUI

ending his three-term dominance on the seat.

Morale boost
For the M.P. unit of Congress, which was low on morale since the nomination of its Rajya Sabha candidate Meenakshi Natarajan was rejected, the victory comes as a booster shot with just two years left for the 2028 State Assembly election.

The Congress managed to present a largely united front throughout the campaigning.

According to Congress insiders, Chief Minister Digvijaya Singh played a key role in candidate selection and management of the caste equation, while State unit chief Jitu Patwari led booth management and intense campaigning.

The ruling BJP, on the other hand, seems to have failed in putting its house in order following protests by Mr. Mishra's supporters after he was snubbed for party ticket. The anger of his loyalists, who form a large chunk of the BJP's lo-

cal cadre and functionaries, appears to have cost the party despite various meetings with Mr. Mishra in Bhopal and New Delhi and efforts by senior leaders to engage with his supporters and local functionaries. It lost various significant booths, including Mr. Mishra's own and that of district president Raghuvir Singh Kushwaha, who had offered to resign after the former was snubbed for the ticket.

State BJP sources point out that workers associated with Mr. Mishra did not put the energy into BJP's campaign. Rumours and allegations that Mr. Mishra "silently supported the Congress candidate" also circulated during the campaigning.

Datia constituency comes under the Gwalior-Chambal region, which has seen the influence of caste factor in electoral politics over the years due to its proximity with Uttar Pradesh.

Kishor gains across the spectrum as voters support his call for change

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

Voters in central Patna's Bankipur Assembly constituency, long considered a stronghold of the BJP, on Monday expressed happiness that Jan Suraj Party's (JSP) Prashant Kishor had won the byelection. People across communities and caste groups, including Muslims, Yadavs, upper castes, and Scheduled Castes, said they had voted for Mr. Kishor.

The BJP fielded Neeraj Kumar Sinha from the seat, which had been represented by the party's national president, Nitin Nabin, who won it for the fifth consecutive time in 2025. Mr. Nabin's father, Navin Kishore Prasad Sinha, had held the seat since 1995.



In jubilation: Jan Suraj Party supporters celebrate Prashant Kishor's win in the Bankipur by-election in Patna on Monday. PTI

'Better alternative'
Deepak Sharma, a member of the Bhumihar community, said: "Prashant Kishor was a better candidate and a better alterna-

tive. He always raised public issues with clarity and boldness. Unlike other political leaders who make lofty promises, he raised the simple slogan – vote for the future of your children. This is something really different from others."

Many upper caste voters felt the BJP had taken them for granted. "The BJP thought that even if it fields an ordinary party worker, the voters will give them their vote. The people of Bankipur have rejected

this mindset. In the entire campaign, the BJP candidate hardly spoke anything. If he cannot speak to the public, how will he speak about our cause in the Assembly?" Akhilesh Mishra, a member of the Brahmin community, said.

'RJD indifferent'
In areas such as Peermuhani and Daldali Road, where SC voters form a sizeable segment of the electorate, residents said Mr. Kishor personally visited these

areas, met members of the community, and urged them to vote for change.

The Yarpur and Jakkanpur areas, which have voters from the Other Backward Classes (OBCs), particularly Yadavs, said the Opposition Rashtriya Janata Dal (RJD) remained largely indifferent throughout the campaign.

"When the campaign was at its peak, Tejashwi Yadavji was on a foreign trip and only joined during the last two days of the campaign. We did not find much enthusiasm and eagerness in the RJD," Mangesh Yadav said.

Large numbers of Muslim voters in the Sabzibagh area also opted to vote for Mr. Kishor. "As everyone knows, our community votes for candidates who can defeat BJP. We did not find that calibre in the RJD candidate while Prashant Kishor was the one giving the BJP tough and sleepless nights," Mohamad Rizwan said.

Consider releasing funds from frozen Trinamool Cong. bank accounts, SC tells ED

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday urged the Enforcement Directorate (ED) to consider allowing the Trinamool Congress access to a portion of the funds lying in three debit-frozen bank accounts, observing that the party would require money to meet its day-to-day expenses. The court, however, made it clear that it would not examine at this stage the merits of the dispute over the legality of the freezing order, which remains pending before the Calcutta High Court.

A Bench of Justices M.M. Sundresh and P.B. Varale was hearing the Trinamool's appeal against a July 20 order of the Calcutta High Court refusing to grant interim relief against the ED's decision as part of a money-laundering investigation. The Bench declined to stay the High Court's order but asked the central agency to obtain instructions on whether a portion of the funds could be released and revert after a week.

"We are not passing any order because it has to be decided by the High Court... We have suggested to both sides that some amount can be released for the administration, for daily expenses and some other necessary expenses," the Bench said.

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NOTICE INVITING TENDER (2nd Call)

Adv. No.(1) TTD-44021(34)/5/2026-PRESS Sec & (2) TTD-44021(34)/7/2026- PRESS e-tenders are invited for Printing and supply of Desktop / Table-Top Calendars (1,25,000 Nos) and Telugu Panchangam Calendars (2,50,000 Nos) of 2027, as per Tender Notice & Details. Please log on to the website <http://www.tirumala.org> and <https://tender.ap.procurement.gov.in> For further details contact : 0877- 2264355, (Or) 0877-2264292.

TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.140),Date: 01.08.2026 **EXECUTIVE OFFICER**

PSPCL Punjab State Power Corporation Limited

Regd. Office: PS&B Head Office, The Mall Patiala- 147001
Phone No. - 96461-18774, Email: td-scmotoringpatiala@gmail.com
Corporate Identity No. U40109PB2010SGC033813 Website: www.pspcl.in

Tender Enquiry No. MQP-266/2026-27/PO(M) dated 30.07.2026

Chief Engineer/Metering, C-3, Shakti Vihar, PSPCL, Patiala invites e-tender for Procurement of Portable Secondary Injection Type CT & PT Test Equipment for Testing of LT/HT/EHT Current Transformers & Potential Transformers.

For detailed NIT & tender specification please refer to <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in> from 30.07.2026, 11:00 AM onwards.

Note: Corrigendum and addendum, if any will be published online at <https://eproc.punjab.gov.in>.

1079/12/2026-27/13885 **C 761/26**

APPOINTMENT

KALAM INSTITUTE OF HEALTH TECHNOLOGY (KIHT)

IMPORTANT UPDATE

KIHT will be conducting interviews for various positions of consultants in KIHT and it's associate organizations. Corresponding job descriptions are available on website www.kiht.in

BIKANER TECHNICAL UNIVERSITY
Karni Industrial Area, Pugal Road, Bikaner 334004
<https://btu.ac.in> and <https://btucam2026.com> Email-id: cam2026@btu.ac.in

CAM 2026

Centralized Admission for M. Tech. and M. Arch. Session 2026-27

Adv. No. BTU/CAM/25-26/Adv/10 Date: 01/08/2026

Online applications are invited for admission to M.Tech. and M.Arch. programs offered by various constituent and affiliated colleges of Bikaner Technical University, Bikaner and affiliated colleges of Rajasthan Technical University, Kota for the academic session 2026-27.

Information brochure, tentative schedule, details of offered specialization, seat matrix of M.Tech./M.Arch., and other relevant information are provided on CAM 2026 Web portal (<https://btucam2026.com>). Fellowship is subject to terms and conditions and approval by AICTE. All the updates or changes will be provided on the CAM 2026 admission portal only. Candidates are advised to visit the web portal of CAM 2026 regularly as all communication will be made available through admission portal only.

Last date of Application Fee Deposit: 14 August 2026
Last date of Application submission: 15 August 2026
Raj.Samwadi/C/26/8450 **Coordinator, CAM 2026**

ODISHA CONSTRUCTION CORPORATION LIMITED
BHUBANESWAR, ODISHA,
PIN:751012, Tel No.(0674) 2562020
e-Mail: theoccltd@odishaconstruction.com;
GSTIN - 21AAAC02571K2ZM

"e"-Procurement Notice No. 13 /OCCL/2026-27 (on-line)

On-line percentage rate tender is invited for the following work :

Sl No.	Name of Work	Name of Division	Bid Identification No.	Approx. Value of Work	Bid Security through On-Line transfer/ie per DTCN (in Rs.)	Period of Completion	Availability & Submission of Tender (on-line)
01	Dredging, Nourishment & Protection to river bank near Lower Ballyatra Ground on Mahanadi Right from Cantonment Gada to Seashore Boat Club for Mahanadi River Front Development Project.	Mahanadi South Division-4 Cuttack	OCCL-GGP/02/2026-27	Rs.41.05 Crore	Rs.41,05,000/-	12 (Twelve) Calendar months	From 06.08.2026 03.30 PM to 20.08.2026 5.30 PM.

Procurement Officer : Managing Director, OCCL.
Date of Opening of the Tender : 21.08.2026, 12.00 Noon onwards.
Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal: <https://www.tendersodisha.gov.in>

MANAGING DIRECTOR
34001/582/2627 **OIPR-34001/34120/1/26-27/0014**

e-mail ID - sepwd_rgda@yahoo.com; Phone/Fax No - 06856 - 223049

OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, RAYAGADA (R&B) CIRCLE, RAYAGADA

e-Procurement Notice

Bid Identification No. C.C.E (RANDB) RGDA-02 / 2026-27 (Online) Dt.01.08.2026

No.971 Date : 01.08.2026

INVITATION FOR BIDS

1.	The Chief Construction Engineer, Rayagada (R&B) Circle, Rayagada on behalf of Governor of Odisha invites percentage rate bids in double cover mode to be received in online mode only for the construction of works as detailed in the table below:	
2.	Nature of Work	Building Works
3.	No. of Works	02 (Two) Nos. of work
4.	Estimated Cost (Approximately)	Rs.267.29 Lakh, and Rs.158.67 Lakhs.
5.	Bid Cost (Online)	Rs.10,000/-
6.	EMD / Bid Security Amount (Online)	One Percentage of the Estimated Cost.
7.	Class of Contractor	B, A and Special Class only as per Financial Eligibility.
8.	Availability of Bid Documents in the website	11.00 Hours of Dt.10.08.2026 to 17.00 Hours of Dt.25.08.2026
9.	Date of Opening of Bid	11.00 Hrs of Dt. 28.08.2026
10.	The Bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only. Further details can be seen from the website : https://tendersorissa.gov.in . Any Addendum / Corrigendum / Cancellation of tender can also be seen in the said website. The authority reserves the right to reject any or all bids without assigning any reason thereof.	

Chief Construction Engineer, Rayagada (R&B) Circle, Rayagada.

34001/580/2627 **OIPR-34001/34154/1/26-27/0002**

INBRIEF



WhatsApp users say their accounts ‘put under review’

Instant messaging app WhatsApp on Monday put multiple accounts, including those in India, “under review” for 24 hours and blocked all the app features, prompting several affected users to flag the issue through social media. When contacted, a WhatsApp spokesperson said, “We are always working to stay ahead of those trying to abuse our service and ban accounts to help keep other users safe. Sometimes we get this wrong and if we do, we try to fix it as quickly as possible to get people back to chatting.” The disruption was highlighted around 8 p.m., when users started facing the issue without any prior warning from the messaging app. PTI

Greater synergy needed in Defence Ministry, says Rajnath

Defence Minister Rajnath Singh on Monday called for deeper integration between the military and civilian components of the Ministry of Defence, saying greater synergy was essential to address evolving security and technological challenges. Addressing the 85th Armed Forces Headquarters (AFHQ) Civilian Services Day celebrations in New Delhi, Mr. Singh said military and administrative integration must progress together, stressing that both uniformed personnel and civilian officials were united by the shared commitment of “Nation First.” He also also released the 34th edition of *Samvad* magazine.

‘Changes in transgender law can’t scrap given rights’

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday orally clarified to the Union government that a new law, seen as dismantling the transgender community’s right to self-identification, will not retrospectively, and by default, invalidate ‘transgender cards’ issued under a previous legislation.

Petitioners, who include activists and community members, pointed out that the importance of the transgender identity cards cannot be trifled away by the Union government.

A lawyer, who identified as a member of the community, said the card was an essential part of her basic identity. “Every day I struggle. It is a struggle to even get a house to live in,” she told a three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant.

Justice Joymalya Bagchi, on the Bench, replied, “We assure you, we are concerned about your rights”.

“Even if there is a change in legislation, the rights conferred or accrued must remain the same,” Justice Bagchi told the Centre, represented by Solicitor General Tushar Mehta.

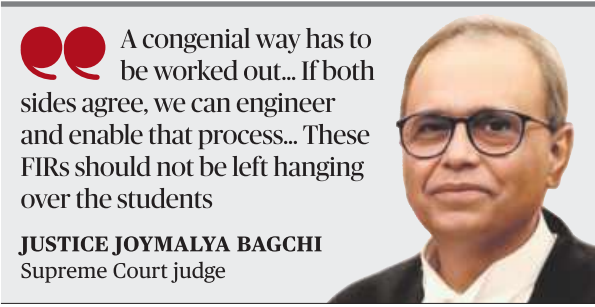
States can withdraw FIRs against July 20 protesters, says SC

Court clarifies the expression ‘criminal antecedents’ used in earlier order meant ‘grave and heinous offences’, suggests ‘classification’ of protesters

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday clarified that its July 28 order would not prevent respective State governments from closing or withdrawing proceedings arising out of FIRs registered against student protesters in accordance with law. The court also clarified that the expression “criminal antecedents”, used in its earlier order to exclude certain protesters from interim protection, referred to “grave and heinous offences”.

The clarification came after a Bench headed by Chief Justice of India (CJI) Surya Kant had, in its July 28 interim order, permitted the NCT of Delhi and other States to “proceed” with the investigation of FIRs registered in connection with the protests, while restraining the authorities from taking coercive action against “protesting students” who did not have “criminal antece-



“If both sides agree, we can engineer and enable that process... These FIRs should not be left hanging over the students”

CJI Kant suggested that a “classification” could be undertaken to distinguish students who had participated peacefully in the demonstrations from “hardened criminals” who may have infiltrated the protests.

Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the Union government and the Delhi Police, submitted that the government was “serious” about its assu-

rance and was engaging with representatives of the BJP to work out the “semanatics” and the appropriate legal mechanism for bringing the criminal proceedings against the protesters to an end.

The Bench observed that a “congenial way” had to be worked out and called for cooperation from both sides.

“If both of you agree, we can engineer and enable that process... These FIRs should not be left hanging over the students,” Justice Joymalya Bagchi said. He added that investigating agencies could file closure reports under the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023 (BNSS).

BJP, Opposition spar in panel meet over Meta’s processes

Sobhana K. Nair
NEW DELHI

In a face-off between the ruling party and Opposition MPs on Monday at the meeting of the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Communications and Information Technology, where Meta representatives were summoned against the backdrop of the recent students’ protests, the BJP members, led by panel Chairperson Nishikant Dubey, demanded an apology from Meta chief Mark Zuckerberg for restricting Prime Minister Narendra Modi’s Facebook post, while the Opposition pushed back, arguing that democracy should not be regulated in the name of regulating technology.

Instagram played a crucial role in the protest, acting both as the platform airing discontent and as a tool to mobilise protesters.

Mr. Dubey warned that the social media company could face action if accountability was not fixed. It is learnt that he has asked Meta to provide a complete audit trail of the post, from “report to restoration”. The restriction, Mr. Dubey reportedly said in his opening remarks at the



Shafi Parambil

meeting, underscored the need for greater oversight of Meta’s content moderation processes, automated systems and recommendation algorithms.

The Opposition pushed back against this line of questioning by Mr. Dubey and other BJP MPs, arguing that content moderation decisions on social media platforms should not be subject to political influence. While raising their own concerns about Meta, particularly on issues of privacy and compliance with Indian laws, they maintained that criticism of the government could not be equated with anti-national content.

Congress MP Shafi Parambil is learnt to have told the meeting that “technology should be regulated, not democracy”, while emphasising that dissent could not be criminalised.

Domestic cruelty rules cover live-in couples: SC

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday said the criminal offence of domestic cruelty would extend to live-in relationships between consenting adults that qualify as “relationships in the nature of marriage”.

The judgment authored by a Bench headed by Justice Sanjay Karol said Section 498A (domestic cruelty) of the Indian Penal Code, now replaced by Sections 85 and 86 of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, should not be limited to married relationships alone. Live-in relationships were a reality in modern, urban life. The law must adapt.

The court reasoned that relationships in the nature of marriage and which show the requisite intent to marry were the “closest to marriage itself”.

Heat stress during pregnancy linked to adverse birth outcomes, says study

Ramya Kannan
CHENNAI

A nationwide analysis of data from the National Family Health Survey (NFHS) quantifies the link between prolonged exposure to extreme heat during pregnancy and adverse birth outcomes in India. It was associated with a measurable increase in the risk of low birthweight, preterm birth and stillbirths among the mothers, and was tied to the trimester during which exposure occurred.

The paper ‘Effect of extreme heat stress on adverse pregnancy outcomes in India’, analysed 209,266 births recorded between 2015 and 2020, and matched each birth to local heat conditions during the pregnancy.

It used nationally representative NFHS-5 data (2019-21) linked to high-resolution heat exposure estimates (India Heat Index)



The study used NFHS-5 data and linked it to high-resolution heat exposure estimates.

for 2015-20 across 707 districts. It uses ‘consecutive sweltering days’ instead of average temperature.

The researchers, Vineetha Vincent *et al*, showed that trimester-specific windows: heat extremes during the first trimester were most linked to preterm birth, the second trimester to low birth weight, and the third trimester showed a higher risk for stillbirth.

The risks were also high-

er among mothers with low Body Mass Index (<18.5), with lower education levels, and from poorer wealth groups, the study concluded.

It also found that urban residents showed slightly higher low birth weight rates than their rural counterparts.

The study also found associations between climatic zones, heat exposure, and pregnancy outcomes – mountainous zones showed stronger associations, while humid subtropical and arid zones also showed significant low birth weight occurrences. This is presented as the first population-scale evidence from India tying prolonged extreme heat stress (not just temperature) to adverse pregnancy outcomes, using a heat index that incorporates humidity, wind, and radiation.

The authors say re-

search evidence already shows the potential biological effects of high ambient temperature: increased maternal core body temperature raises foetal core temperature, leading to birth defects, and dehydration decreases uterine blood flow and foetal growth, and due to reduced blood flow, there is a heightened chance of uterine contractions and an increased risk of pre-term birth.

The study was led by researchers at the University of Queensland – IIT Delhi Academy of Research, in association with the Indian Institute of Technology Delhi (Centre for Atmospheric Sciences and School of Public Policy) and the University of Queensland’s School of Public Health, Brisbane, University of New South Wales, Sydney; the University of Exeter, U.K.; and Korea University, Seoul.

Youth part of Kanwar Yatra attack school vehicle, trigger row

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

A school van carrying students was attacked with stones allegedly by a group of youth who were part of the Kanwar Yatra, at Charak Crossing in Chowk police station limits in Lucknow on Monday. The Lucknow Police booked three unidentified individuals after the incident. The police have not confirmed their identity and a search is on to trace them.

In his complaint, Amir, the driver of the van, alleged that a group of youth riding motorcycles had thrown stones at the vehicle and also threatened to kill him before fleeing.

The case has been registered under Sections 131 (attack on another person without any reason) and 351(2) (criminal intimidation) of the Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita (BNS).

Top court asks govt. to ensure safe footpaths

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI:

The Supreme Court directed the Union government on Monday to provide pedestrians broad, clearly-marked footpaths exclusively for their use.

A Bench headed by Justice P.S. Narasimha said the right to a clean and broad footpath was a fundamental right the state could afford to everyone without any big investment. “Wherever there is a road, there should be space for walkers. Make sure these spaces are not encroached upon,” Justice Narasimha addressed Additional Solicitor-General K.M. Nataraj before posting the case after a fortnight.

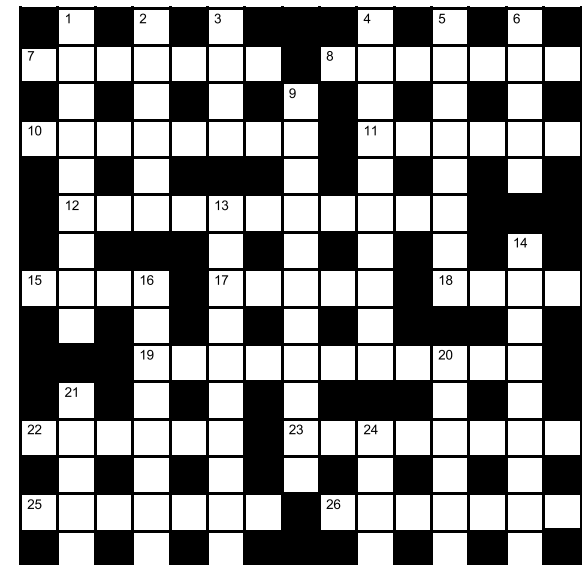
On June 19, the apex court had declared the right to walk on demarcated and well-maintained footpaths a fundamental right.

THE CROSSWORD+ 14863

(set by Vidwan)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at <https://thehindu.com/crosswords>

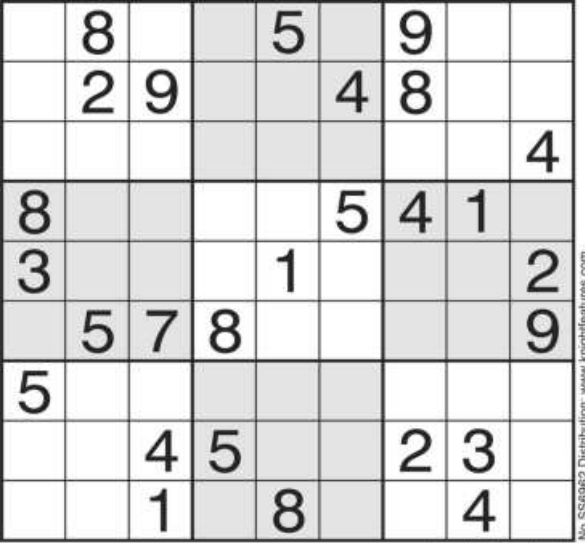
SCAN TO PLAY



- Across**
- 7 Noble lion killed for piece of beef (7)
8 Small food shop with good, hot slice of taco! That is Joy! (7)
10 Better if solicitor spends time with head of monastery at church (8)
11 America about to tax entry (6)
12 Vicky spent time in kitchen, prepared Ukrainian delicacy (7,4)

- 15 Housing for the poorest, fifty in total (4)
17 Curtsy King and Knight with bare heels (5)
18 Bay blowing cold smell (4)
19 Ruth got cash distributed for having an urgent universal urge for relief (6,5)
22 Scream - an animation movie about India (6)
23 Vigorous Chelsea occasionally occupying space at the top (8)
25 Dirty as beer fermented with piece of meat (7)
26 Second revolt over England withdrawing basic rail support (7)
Down
1 Tiny men in America, run away from cruel fights (9)
2 Boot past student, possibly out on a limb (6)
3 Means racket time (4)
4 Coy sculler regularly participating in swimming games for unit (10)
5 Just not following chapter on B-52 support for ground troops, for instance (3,5)
6 Leader of Xanadu, has fights over love for some African language (5)
9 Kind of cloud below, he almost gets in the puff (11)
13 Revolutionary British King and Luxembourg Knight plan faceless American supremacist organisation (2,4,4)
14 Related to troubles in red tape (9)
16 Manliness? Male suffering, for the most part, is minute and ordinary! (8)
20 Old boy looked and followed (6)
21 Trace quiet communist (5)
24 Dance and haul away (4)

SUDOKU



Solution to previous puzzle

Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

INBRIEF



Government hikes export levy on petrol, diesel and ATF

In its latest fortnightly review, the government increased the export levy on petrol to ₹3.5 per litre, on diesel to ₹24 per litre and the levy on aviation turbine fuel (ATF) to ₹22 per litre. The excise levy on petrol and diesel for domestic consumption remains unchanged. In the previous fortnightly review on July 16, export levy on petrol was reduced to ₹2.5 per litre, while that on ATF and diesel was increased to ₹15.5 per litre and ₹14.5 per litre respectively. Against the backdrop of the West Asia crisis, the government has instituted export levies since March 27 to ensure adequate domestic availability of the retail fuels by disincentivising exports. The rates are reviewed on a fortnightly basis. The effective rates are prescribed based on the then prevailing average international prices of crude oil, petrol, diesel and jet fuel since the prior review.

Essar Group plans £4.3 bn U.K. energy transition investment

India's Essar Group plans to invest £4.3 billion (\$5.79 billion) to build low-carbon energy transition projects in the U.K. by 2035, it said in a statement on Monday. Essar Energy Transition Fuels (EETF), a unit of Essar Group, operates a 2,00,000-barrels-per-day Stanlow refinery. The 4.3-billion-pound investment pipeline will support the U.K.'s energy transition, "generating massive long-term economic value, and creating thousands of highly skilled jobs," said Prashant Ruia, Chairman of EETF. Of the planned investment, more than £1 billion are nearing final investment decision to transform Stanlow into a leading energy transition hub, the statement said. Essar is expanding its retail network in the UK and aims to supply 800 new locations with its fuels. Essar is also exploring building data centres near the Stanlow project. REUTERS

TRAI strengthens call quality app; telcos, public get access to reports

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Telecom Regulatory Authority of India (TRAI) unveiled an application to report issues with call quality for Android devices. The MyCall app allows users to score any given call's quality out of five, and report specific issues such as echoes, low audio quality and inaudible calls. The app's insights will be analysed by the regulator after collecting anonymised data on its own servers and low quality calls will also have signal strength, location and other data sent to telecom operators for them to improve systems, TRAI chairperson Anil Kumar



The app's insights will be analysed by the regulator.

Lahoti said.

Publicly available
The data will also eventually become publicly available in some form, Mr. Lahoti said. TRAI is not inclined to mandate the installation of this app on

smartphones via phone makers, Mr. Lahoti said responding to a question. The MyCall app existed for years but most of the features unveiled on Monday were not available till the revamp. The app follows the footsteps of DND and MySpeed, TRAI's revamped apps focusing on spam call, SMS reporting and Internet speed test.

Call quality
TRAI has attempted multiple times to hold telcos responsible for call drops and call quality. A decade ago, it attempted to put in a micro-penalty framework to compensate customers for dropped calls. Telcos successfully argued in the Delhi High Court and the Su-

preme Court stating laws of physics made it impossible to guarantee a call wouldn't drop. In recent years, TRAI worked on financial disincentives under multiple regulations, including the 2024 Standards of Quality of Service of Access (Wireline and Wireless) and Broadband (Wireline And Wireless) Service Regulations to require frequent audits and meeting certain quality benchmarks. Not meeting such benchmarks leads to a disincentive.

Older technologies
Inter-telco call quality is limited due to older technologies used to interconnect such calls between different operators.

Manufacturing growth falls to 5-year low in July: PMI

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

India's manufacturing sector's growth fell to a five-year low in July on slower rise in new business orders amid increasingly challenging market conditions, a monthly survey showed on Monday.

The seasonally-adjusted HSBC India Manufacturing Purchasing Managers' Index (PMI) fell from 54.2 in June to 53.5 in July – the lowest since August 2021 and below the long-run series average of 54.2.

The PMI index is a gauge of overall conditions based on new orders, output,

Job creation across manufacturing industry weakened for third straight month in July

employment, supplier delivery times and stocks of purchases. A print above 50 means expansion while a score below 50 denotes contraction. In July, growth in new orders was the second-weakest in over four years.

It indicated advertising and demand resilience supported sales, which were somewhat curbed by increasingly challenging market conditions.

India mulls tax relief for offshore funds using local managers

Reuters
MUMBAI

India has proposed tax law amendments to shield offshore investment funds from Indian tax liabilities when they route investments through India-based fund managers, a draft bill showed.

The proposed change comes as the country faces significant foreign outflows, prompting the government to take measures to attract overseas investors by easing access. Investors have long complained about aggressive tax administration in India. The government de-

scribed the new rules as being framed "in order to promote fund management activity and provide tax certainty."

An email query sent to India's Finance Ministry was not answered immediately.

Under the existing rules, an offshore fund must maintain a minimum corpus of ₹1 billion (\$10.49 million), have at least 20 investors, and cap any single investor's contribution at 25% in order to be shielded from Indian tax. Funds that fail to meet these conditions risk having their India-sourced profits taxed at rates of up to 38%.

Business

India may extend tax breaks for contract manufacturing

The extension up to March 31, 2041 is 'to provide (tax) certainty', according to a draft of the proposed tax amendments; move a major win for Apple which had lobbied for such changes

Reuters
NEW DELHI

India has proposed extending tax exemptions until 2041 for foreign companies that provide machinery to contract manufacturers, handing a major win to Apple which had lobbied for such changes, and is fast expanding in the market.

India has been a key market for Apple as it diversifies iPhone manufacturing beyond China, and the South Asian nation is set to make 26% of the world's iPhones in 2026, up from 6% four years ago, according to Counterpoint Research. According to a draft of the proposed tax amendments seen by Reuters, "to provide (tax) certainty" the government has extended tax breaks



Apple lobbied to ensure it is not taxed for ownership of the high-end iPhone machinery it provides to its contract manufacturers. AP

until March 31, 2041 to foreign companies that provide equipment to their contract manufacturers in India. India introduced the tax exemption for foreign companies in February, valid only until 2031, after Apple lobbied the Indian government to modify its income tax laws to ensure the company is not taxed

for ownership of the high-end iPhone machinery it provides to its contract manufacturers.

Apple had feared that, unlike in China, tax laws in India could treat ownership of machinery supplied to its contract manufacturers as "business connection", exposing its iPhone profits to tax.

The extended tax exemption will apply to manufacturers of mobile phones, tablets, laptops, hearing and wearable electronic devices, as per the draft bill that will have to be passed by both houses of Parliament.

Storing components

India has exempted from tax foreign firms' income from storing and providing parts used to manufacture such electronics components to contract manufacturers until 2041.

The rule will apply to factories and warehouses in customs-bonded areas, which are technically considered being outside India's customs border.

If devices are sold within India from such factories, they will attract import taxes.

ONGC to reserve half of Mangaluru facility for strategic reserves

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

State-owned Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) will reserve half of its 1.75 million metric tonne (MMT) oil storage facility in Mangaluru as a strategic storage, Suresh Gopi, Minister of State (MoS) for Petroleum and Natural Gas, told Rajya Sabha on Monday.

Mr. Gopi also informed that the rest of the capacity would be available for commercial use.

"ONGC is developing a strategic petroleum reserve facility of 1.75 MMT capacity at Mangaluru. 50% of this storage will be reserved as strategic storage and rest of the capacity will be available to ONGC for commercial operations," he told Parliament. The project would be entirely funded by it.

Mr. Gopi also told the



A view of ONGC's advanced drilling rig. File @LG_LADAKH X/ANI

House that India's current storage capacity for crude oil and petroleum products could meet 74 days of its net crude import requirements.

He said the government had chalked out plans to build a storage capacity of 6.5 MMT, including the 4 MMT capacity in Odisha's Chandikhol and Karnataka's Padur.

On Chandikhol, he said "the estimated project cost is about ₹9,000 crores."

Government to sell up to 6.5% stake in LIC at ₹382 per share

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The government will sell up to a 6.5% stake in Life Insurance Corporation (LIC) at a floor price of ₹382 per share through a two-day offer for sale (OFS) beginning Tuesday.

The issue opens for non-retail investors on Tuesday and for retail investors on Wednesday.

If fully subscribed, the sale of over 82.22 crore

shares or a 6.5% stake at the given floor price will fetch about ₹31,000 crore to the disinvestment kitty.

"Government offers to disinvest 2.5% equity with an additional 4% as a green shoe option," Department of Investment and Public Asset Management (DIPAM) Secretary Arunish Chawla said in a post on X.

The floor price is at a 10% discount over Monday's closing price of the insurer's shares of ₹424.35



The stake sale will help LIC meet the minimum public shareholding requirement mandated by SEBI ahead of schedule. REUTERS

on the BSE. The stake sale will help LIC achieve the minimum public shareholding requirement man-

dated by market regulator SEBI ahead of schedule.

SEBI had given LIC time till May 16, 2027, to achieve a minimum 10% public shareholding.

Present stake

At present, the government holds a 96.5% stake in LIC. It had earlier sold 3.5% through an initial public offering (IPO) in May 2022 at a price band of ₹902-949 per share, raising about ₹21,000 crore.

LIC currently has a market capitalisation of over ₹5.36 lakh crore.

LIC shares settled at ₹424.35 on Monday, down 0.12% over the previous close on BSE.

So far, in the current fiscal, the government has mopped up ₹21,082 crore through stake sale in seven public sector undertakings (PSUs) and remittances from SUTI (Specified Undertaking of the Unit Trust of India).

BUSINESS CONNECT

A Business Initiative

Regal Jewellers Launched in Chennai



Regal Jewellers, one of South India's leading jewellery manufacturer and wholesalers, has officially entered the Tamil Nadu market with the launch of its first showroom at North Usman Road, T. Nagar, Chennai. Marking a significant milestone in the brand's 48-year journey, the new showroom introduces Regal Jewellers' unique manufacturer-direct model to Tamil Nadu. The showroom was inaugurated by Speaker Thiru J. C. D. Prabhakar, in the presence of MLA, V. M. S. Mustafa, Chairman, Sivadasan TK, MD and CEO Mr. Vibin Shivdas, other senior government officials, distinguished guests and members of the public who gathered to celebrate Regal Jewellers' arrival in Tamil Nadu. Expressing his gratitude, MD and CEO of Regal Jewellers, Mr. Vibin Shivdas, said: "We are truly grateful for the warm welcome Chennai has given Regal Jewellers."

Indian Bank's 120th Foundation Day



As part of its 120th Foundation Day celebrations, Indian Bank launched a series of commemorative activities under the banner "Foundation Day Fortnight" across its Corporate Office and Field General Manager Offices. Shri Binod Kumar, Managing Director and Chief Executive Office, was joined by the Executive Directors, Ashutosh Choudhury, Shiv Bajrang Singh, Ms Mini T.M., and Shri V Anand, Chief Vigilance Officer of the Bank. They planted saplings, symbolising its commitment to environmental sustainability. Celebrating its Foundation Day every year on 15th August, the Bank conducted Anna Sewa Abhiyan at Ramakrishna Mission Students' Home, Myslapore, Chennai, to provide free meals to inmates of orphanages and senior citizens' homes throughout the month of August across Chennai and pan India.

Tanishq Unveils 'Narumugai' Series



Tanishq, the jewellery brand from Titan, has launched Narumugai, its first South India-exclusive Uncut Diamond Open Polki collection, inspired by the timeless beauty of Mallipoo (jasmine) and the spirit of the Pudhumai Penn: the modern Tamil woman rooted in tradition yet confident in her individuality. Crafted in 18K gold with superior-quality Uncut Diamonds, the collection reimagines iconic forms such as the Attigai, Mango Maala and Haaram through contemporary design. Arun Narayan, CEO, Jewellery Division, Titan Company Ltd. Stated, "With Narumugai, we are proud to introduce Tanishq's first Uncut Diamond collection created exclusively for the South Indian market." Customers can enjoy up to Rs. 601 per gram off on plain gold jewellery as part of Tanishq's limited period Aadi festive offers.

Chennai Port Records Milestones



Chennai Port Authority recently achieved multiple operational milestones, setting a new single-day record by handling 46,000 MT of Barytes exports through M.V. Nafisa Jahan, surpassing its previous record of 45,200 MT set in 2022. The Port also successfully handled 13,208 MT of Pig Iron, a new cargo commodity, under its NCCS 2026-27 incentive scheme. Further strengthening its infrastructure, Chairperson Shri Sachin S. Kurve, I.A.S. inaugurated three 100-tonne Harbour Mobile Cranes with 51-metre outreach, capable of handling bulk, break bulk, project cargo and containers. Congratulating all stakeholders, he said the achievements reflect Chennai Port's commitment to operational excellence, infrastructure modernisation and customer-centric services.

Lille by Challani Opens in Selayiur



Lille by Challani, an exclusive venture from Challani Jewellery Mart, introduces a contemporary range of lightweight Gold, Diamond, and Platinum jewellery designed for women aged 16–34. Blending style, comfort, affordability, and customization, the brand offers earrings, pendants, necklaces, bangles, colour stone collections, and certified BIS hallmarked jewellery. Lille also features dedicated Men's and Kids' collections, alongside an elegant diamond range adorned with precious stones including ruby, emerald, sapphire, turquoise, and amethyst. Designed to celebrate individuality, the collection caters to both everyday wear and special occasions. The showroom will be inaugurated by actor Dushara Vijayan at 210, Velachery Main Road, Sembakkam, Selayiur. Lille aims to make meaningful, modern jewellery accessible for every generation.

DNC Chits Honours Employees



DNC Chits which has been serving Tamil Nadu for over 60 years with its registered office in Dharmapuri and headquarters in Chennai, organised a special awards ceremony and family gathering at Valluvar Art Gallery, Valluvar Kottam, Chennai. The event was attended by DNC Group Chairman D.C. Elangovan, directors, regional heads, senior officials, legal advisors, and representatives of Dreams Alliance Matrimony and Exnora International Foundation. Employees who contributed to the organisation's growth were recognised with special awards, promotions, increments, and prizes. Long-serving personnel were also honoured with two-wheelers, commemorative watches, and special awards. The event concluded with games and activities for employees and their families, with officials, staff members, friends, and well-wishers participating in the celebrations.

Russian air strike on warehouse in Ukraine burns eight million books



Myanmar junta releases latest photos of detained leader Suu Kyi



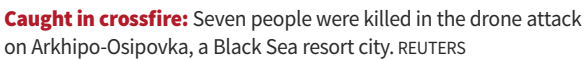
35 killed after Sudan Army drone strike on RSF-held village in Darfur



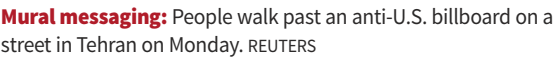
Nauru, the world's third smallest country, changes name to Naoero



Agence France-Presse
MOSCOW



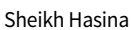
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Kallol Bhattacharjee
NEW DELHI



CM
YK

CHALLENGE COMPLETE

‘Bringing home a gold medal feels like a massive accomplishment’



Competing in the 48kg category is difficult, and managing the weight while training is a huge challenge. But this is a part of our life, and I faced it. Having faced all that and to bring home a (CWG) gold medal feels like a massive accomplishment. I'll certainly put in my best effort for Asian Games — Mirabai Chanu, weightlifter.

REWARD

Sports Minister felicitates CWG weightlifting medallists



Sports Minister Mansukh Mandaviya on Monday felicitated India's Commonwealth Games weightlifting medallists. The Indian lifters returned with eight medals — one gold, six silver and a bronze. Mandaviya presented cash awards of ₹30 lakh to gold medallists, ₹20 lakh to silver medallists and ₹10 lakh to the bronze medallist.

WHO NEXT?

Markram not fussed about the prospect of leading LSG in next IPL



Aiden Markram said he hasn't given much thought to the prospect of leading LSG in the IPL next year, leaving the decision of finding Rishabh Pant's replacement to the franchise. "There are some quality leaders in that group, so I'm not too fussed about it. Whoever gets it, I'm sure will take it on and do a good job," he said.

SEASONED CAMPAIGNER

Chelsea signs veteran midfielder Henderson on a two-year deal



Chelsea announced the signing of veteran England midfielder Jordan Henderson from Premier League rival Brentford on Monday. The former Liverpool captain, who was part of England's World Cup squad at the recent tournament in North America, has signed a two-year deal at Stamford Bridge.

Glasgow passes baton to Ahmedabad in a glitzy affair

The closing ceremony seamlessly blends the finest of Scotland's music, culture and heritage with India's rich traditions that showcase the values of unity, friendship and hospitality in a fitting finale

C'WEALTH GAMES

K. Keerthivasan
GLASGOW

As Glasgow bid farewell to the Commonwealth Games with a grand and colourful closing ceremony at the OVO Hydro here on Sunday, perhaps no words captured the spirit of the host city better than those of celebrated Scottish poet Jackie Kay.

In a moving love letter to Glasgow, with a backdrop of videos showing residents at the city's iconic landmarks, Kay posed a simple yet profound question: "What is Glasgow if not a place of welcome to the citizens of the world?"

It was a sentiment that resonated throughout the 11-day Games, during which the Scottish city earned widespread praise for its warmth, hospitality and impeccable organisation.

The ceremonial handover of the Commonwealth Games flag to Olympic and World champion Neeraj Chopra, Indian Olympic Association president P.T. Usha and the Deputy Chief Minister of

Gujarat, Harsh Sanghavi, accompanied by the voice of Scottish singer Shereen Cutkelvin, symbolically transferred the Games from Glasgow to Ahmedabad, host of the 2030 (centenary) Games.

When the Indian cultural show began, the Indian audience erupted in joy.

Titled 'The World is One Family: Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam', the opening ensemble celebrated the enduring Indian philosophy of universal brotherhood while commemorating the 150th anniversary of the National song *Vande Mataram*. Led by actress and former Miss World Manushi Chhillar, with a musical score by Shankar Mahadevan and choreography by Shiamak Davar and his troupe, the performance presented India's rich cultural heritage and its message of unity and hospitality to the world.

Shankar Mahadevan's sons Shivam and Siddharth, along with the energetic performance of renowned Gujarati and Bollywood playback singer Bhoomi Trivedi, added more vibrancy and heft to the spectacle and brought the Indian segment alive on the stage.

Earlier, singer-song writer Sandi Thom set the tone for the night with the number 'Proud to Be From Scotland', accompanied by the tribal drum band Clann An Drumma.

Australian singer Delta Goodrem then welcomed the athletes with a medley of her greatest hits as volunteers carrying the flags of the 74 participating nations and territories entered the arena. She followed it with a stirring rendition of Warrior, accompanied by archive footage celebrating memorable moments from the Games.

Goodrem later invited Scottish singer Cammy Barnes onto the stage, and the duo performed John Farnham's popular rock anthem 'You're the Voice', backed by a choir and traditional Scottish pipers, drawing one of the loudest cheers of the evening.

Gaining momentum

The celebrations gathered further momentum as Primal Scream's hit 'Loaded' came alive through a fine collaboration featuring bagpipers, community performers and Glaswegian-Nigerian rapper Bemz.

Final medals table (top-5)

Country	G	S	B	Total
Australia	70	45	56	171
England	29	45	36	110
Canada	19	20	23	62
INDIA	13	17	9	39
Scotland	13	9	17	39

The mood then turned reflective with Kay's poignant poem before the spotlight shifted to electrotrad band 'Elephant Sessions'. Their pulsating performance, accompanied by poet and musician Hamish Kiernan-Hutcherson, showcased Glasgow's contemporary spirit.

Later, Scotland's para-athlete Melanie Woods received the David Dixon Award, presented to the outstanding athlete of the Games.

Overall, it was a fitting finale to a glitzy show that seamlessly blended the finest of Scotland's music, culture and heritage with India's rich traditions that showcased the values of unity, friendship and hospitality that perhaps best define the Commonwealth spirit.



See you in 2030! The ceremonial handover of the flag to Neeraj, IOA chief Usha and Gujarat Deputy CM Sanghavi has symbolically transferred the Games from Glasgow to Ahmedabad. Boxer Jaismine leads the Indian contingent in the closing ceremony. REUTERS & PTI

Bumrah injury blow for India, Nabi gets maiden Test call-up

CRICKET

Amol Karhadkar
NEW DELHI

India's chances of keeping its faint World Test Championship (WTC) final hopes alive suffered a setback as Jasprit Bumrah was ruled out of the two-Test series against Sri Lanka after failing to make a complete recovery from a left knee injury.

The Board of Control for Cricket in India (BCCI) confirmed on Monday that the premier fast bowler has failed to obtain the required fitness clearance after sustaining the injury during the ODI series against England. Jammu and Kashmir pacer Auqib Nabi has been drafted into the squad as Bumrah's replacement, earning his maiden senior India call-up.

When the Ajit Agarkar-led selection committee announced the squad last week, both Bumrah and B. Sai Sudharsan had been included subject to fitness clearance from the BCCI's Centre of Excellence. While Bumrah has fallen short of the benchmark, Sai Sudharsan is understood to have made significant progress in his rehabilitation and is expected to be cleared before the team departs for Sri Lanka



A special one: A spot in the Test squad is the highpoint of Nabi's career. FILE PHOTO: K. MURALI KUMAR

on August 4.

Bumrah's absence is a significant blow to Shubman Gill's side ahead of a series India cannot afford to lose if it is to preserve its remote chances of qualifying for the World Test Championship final. The 32-year-old has been India's spearhead across formats, and his experience will be particularly missed in conditions where India is expected to rely on disciplined fast bowling alongside the spin attack.

For Nabi, meanwhile, the call-up marks the culmination of a remarkable rise in domestic cricket. Having collected 104 wickets across the last two Ranji Trophy seasons, including 60 in the 2025-26 cam-

paign, he played a central role in Jammu and Kashmir's maiden Ranji Trophy triumph.

The right-arm seamer also impressed on the recent India-A tour of Sri Lanka, claiming six wickets in two First Class matches, performances that strengthened his credentials before the selectors turned to him following Bumrah's withdrawal.

The updated squad:

Shubman Gill (Capt.), K.L. Rahul (Vice-capt.), Yashasvi Jaiswal, Rishabh Pant (wk), Sai Sudharsan (subject to fitness clearance), Dhruv Jurel (wk), Ravindra Jadeja, Kuldeep Yadav, Manav Suthar, Mohammed Siraj, Prasidh Krishna, Gurnoor Brar, Devdutt Padikkal, Saransh Jain, and Auqib Nabi.

Greaves, Chase fifties lift West Indies to 344

Associated Press
PORT OF SPAIN

The West Indies batters frustrated Pakistan before the home team was bowled out for 344 on the stroke of lunch on day two of the second and final Test on Tuesday.

The visiting side was 136 for two at the time of going to the press.

Earlier, Justin Greaves top-scored with 73 and captain Roston Chase made a defiant 70 as West Indies achieved a decent total on a wicket already showing plenty of assistance to the slow bowlers.

Pick of the bowlers

Off-break bowler Sajid Khan took four for 85 while left-arm spinner Ali Usman, playing in his second Test, Mohammad Ali and Ubaid Shah claimed two wickets apiece.

Resuming on 239 for

five in the first innings, Chase and Greaves extended their sixth-wicket stand to 96.

Ali then struck immediately, after captain Babar Azam had given him the second new ball, as the inform Greaves was caught at point.

Kemar Roach should have been out without scoring, but Pakistan didn't go for the television review despite replays showing Ali's ball could have hit leg stump. He went on to score 19.

Chase completed his half-century before he was undone by debutant fast bowler Ubaid, who nipped one back to bowl him.

Sajid then took the last three wickets.

The scores: West Indies 344 in 105.4 overs (Brandon King 46, Justin Greaves 73, Roston Chase 70, Sajid Khan 4/85) vs Pakistan 136/2 in 31 overs (Azan Awaiz 55). Toss: WI.



Holding fort: Greaves led West Indies' fightback in the second Test at Queen's Park Oval. AFP

Jersey row: Tirkey slams Hockey India DG, seeks detailed reply to queries

EXCLUSIVE

Uthra Ganesan
NEW DELHI

The jersey controversy in Indian hockey has now developed into a full-blown internal battle with Hockey India president Dilip Tirkey taking strong exception to the less-than-satisfactory response on his notice seeking details on the uniform change.

Tirkey had earlier sought an explanation on the process and basis for the change from HI Director General Cdr. R.K. Srivastava, who had claimed that such operational decisions were not brought before the Executive Board earlier as well. Tirkey has now shot back and, on Monday, directed Srivastava to file a point-by-point response to the objections raised in a fresh mail addressed to all Executive Board members, a copy of which is with *The Hindu*.

Declaring that "Hockey India does not own Indian hockey. We are trustees and custodians of a National sporting legacy," he directed Srivastava to respond latest by Tuesday, adding that "A response consisting only of general explanations or assertions



Tirkey. FILE PHOTO: M. VEDHAN

without supporting documentary evidence will not enable the Executive Board to discharge its constitutional responsibilities."

Questioning under whose authority the decision to change was taken, Tirkey asked Srivastava to provide the specific authority, approval or delegation under which the decision to change the official jersey was taken, timeline of the change, names, designations and roles of every person involved in the process and copies of all internal correspondence relating to the decision.

Tirkey wrote, "Please clarify whether the potential impact of the change on athlete's preparation, confidence, comfort, mental focus and competition readiness was assessed. Further, members of the

men's National team were required to address questions relating to the jersey change in the media immediately before the World Cup. Please clarify whether the possible impact of this situation on athlete's focus, mental preparation and tournament readiness was assessed before the announcement."

He has also asked for details of the players and team staff consulted, the feedback and documentary evidence of the same and details of any testing conducted before the kit was officially introduced.

The mail also aims to mark clear boundaries in the roles and powers of the elected members of the federation and appointed employees.

"The Hockey India Bye-Laws establish a governance structure under which the elected bodies of Hockey India are responsible for the governance, policy direction and overseeing the Federation.

"The Director General has an important executive and administrative role. However, administrative responsibility cannot be interpreted as replacing or overriding the authority of the elected governance bodies," he further wrote.

Devyanshi Bihani

Taipei is the city of Tai Tzu-ying. For more than a decade, the former World No. 1 turned badminton into theatre, delighting spectators with strokes that seemed to bend geometry and deception that left opponents frozen.

On Sunday, the tournament found another teenage champion who left Taipei with a place in its history. At 17 years and 222 days, Tanvi Sharma became the youngest Taipei Open champion since Tzu-ying, who won the title at 18 years and 85 days.

It was a fitting coincidence. For much of the week, Tanvi's badminton too was defined not by brute force alone but by exquisite timing, late deception and a striking ease of shot-making that belied her age.

She defeated Vietnam's Thuy Linh Nguyen 21-16, 21-16 in the final to lift her maiden BWF World Tour Super 300 title. Before soaking up the applause, she slipped her gold medal off her neck and placed it around coach Park Tae-sang's neck. Later, the South Korean revealed that there had been moments when he had wondered whether he should leave India, but said Tanvi's victory had given him "another powerful source of motivation to keep moving forward" after more than four years without a title.

Next gen

Indian badminton has been searching for the next leading woman ever since Saina Nehwal and P.V. Sindhu transformed the sport in the country. Every promising teenager has inevitably been measured against the two Olympic medallists.

But breakthroughs are remembered not just for the trophies, but for the style they reveal. Long before titles accumulate, the finest players develop an identity. Taipei offered the first clear glimpse of Tanvi's. If Saina's game was built on relentless pace and Sindhu's on imposing physicality and steep cross-court smashes, Tanvi's greatest weapon may well be her timing.

The shuttle seems to leave her racquet a fraction later than expected, making her intentions harder to read. Her drops and smashes emerge from nearly identical preparation. Opponents find themselves moving backwards, only to be dragged sharply forward. Even when rallies appear routine, she possesses the ability to inject sudden pace with a wristy straight smash or produce a delicate net shot that catches the opponent leaning the wrong way.

Those qualities were on full display throughout the week in the Taiwanese capital. Tanvi opened her campaign by defeating compatriot Tasnim Mir 21-16, 22-20 before overcoming Indonesia's Titis Rahayu Widayawan 21-17, 22-20 in the second round. In both matches, the second game went down to the wire, with the teenager refusing to let tight scorelines alter her attacking instincts.

The level of opposition only grew tougher thereafter. In the quarterfinals, Tanvi stunned fourth seed Supanida Katethong of Thailand 21-15, 18-21, 21-14 before producing one of her most commanding performances of the week in the semifinal.

Facing local favourite Huang Yu-Hsun, ranked 10 places above her, Tanvi barely allowed the Taiwanese shuttler to settle, winning 21-17, 21-11. Her deceptive pushes to the back line, cross-court smashes and deft forecourt play repeatedly left Huang rooted, while a brief wobble late in the opening game proved little more than a passing interruption in an otherwise dominant display.

Against Nguyen in the final, Tanvi repeatedly opened up the court by concealing her drops with the same action as her smash before unleashing steep winners from either flank. She raced to a 10-2 lead in the opening game, repeatedly wrong-footing the experienced Vietnamese with deft touches at the net and powerful strokes.

The scoreline, however, does not fully capture the match.

Like many gifted teenagers, Tanvi occasionally allowed brilliance and impatience to coexist. A flurry of

A fraction late, a step ahead

Indian badminton has waited years for its next great identity after Saina and Sindhu. In Taipei, Tanvi's timing and disguise offered the clearest answer yet

The transition from junior promise to senior consistency is one of the toughest in the sport. India has produced gifted juniors before only to discover that success at higher levels demands far greater physical endurance, tactical discipline and mental resilience than talent alone can provide



BIG LEAP: Tanvi, a silver medallist in the World junior tournament at Guwahati last year, is basking in glory through her senior exploits in Taipei now. FILE PHOTO: RITU RAJ KONWAR

unforced errors allowed Nguyen to close the gap to 10-8 in the opening game before Tanvi steadied herself to take it 21-16. The second game began with the Indian trailing 0-3, but she quickly wrested back control to lead 8-4 and later 15-8, mixing her trademark smash with clever deception at the net. There were brief lapses again, but Tanvi repeatedly produced moments of quality at crucial junctures, refusing to allow Nguyen's comeback to gather momentum to close out another 21-16 victory.

It is perhaps this blend of audacity and vulnerability that makes her game so compelling. That balance is quite unusual for a player still only 17. More importantly, her mistakes never dented

her confidence to stay on the front foot. Even though she admitted to feeling nervous during the tournament, Tanvi continued trusting the strokes that had carried her into the final rather than retreating into safety.

"I was quite nervous, but I just thought I would give my 100%," she said. That composure was built alongside coach Park Tae-sang, who has added focus to her explosive strokeplay. "I'm very happy to win this title. I didn't expect to win a title here. I just thought I'd give my best. So I was going step by step, match by match."

Beyond the title

The triumph also places her among an exclusive group of Indian women to have won a BWF World Tour Super 300 title, joining Saina, Sindhu and Devika Sihag. More importantly, it comes at an opportune moment, with the BWF World Championships in New Delhi later this month.

The transition from junior promise to senior consistency is one of the toughest in the sport. India has produced gifted juniors before, only to discover that success at higher levels demands far greater physical endurance, tactical discipline and mental resilience than talent alone can provide.

Tanvi's own journey already reflects that progression. A former World Junior No. 1, she became the first Indian to win two medals at a single edition of the World Junior Championships, claiming silver in girls' singles and bronze in the mixed team event. She reached the final of the U.S. Open Super 300 last year, finished runner-up at the Odisha Masters and Guwahati Masters, and was part of India's historic Asian Team Championships triumph.

Taipei was not an overnight

breakthrough. It was another milestone on a steadily rising trajectory.

There will inevitably be tougher tests ahead. Tanvi knows that better than anyone. Even after lifting the biggest title of her young career, she spoke less about the triumph than the effort it took to get there. "It was pretty hard for me as well, playing five matches. I just needed to be consistent," she said, before adding that she still needed to "work harder" to compete regularly at the Super 500 and Super 750 level.

'A special player'

Sindhu, one of only three other Indian women to have won a BWF World Tour Super 300 title, perhaps summed it up best. Congratulating Tanvi on social media, the two-time Olympic medallist wrote that the teenager had "all the ingredients to become a very special player", praising her talent, stroke-making and courage to take on the best.

The ingredients are certainly there. Natural timing cannot be taught. Neither can the instinct to disguise strokes until the last possible moment or the confidence to attack under pressure. Sindhu added that stability and experience had been the only missing pieces, calling the Taipei triumph "just the beginning" for one of Indian badminton's brightest young prospects.

Moreover, Taipei has long had a habit of revealing special talents. Saina won the title there in 2008 before going on to redefine Indian badminton. Tzu-ying, the hometown favourite, also announced herself there as a teenager before redefining what artistry on a badminton court could look like. Tanvi's journey is only beginning, but her victory carried echoes of both - Saina's fearless ambition and Tzu-ying's genius for deception and timing.

THE GIST

Tanvi became the youngest Taipei Open champion since Tzu-ying, winning her maiden BWF World Tour Super 300 title at just 17 years and 222 days

The title ended an 18-year wait for an Indian women's singles champion at the Taipei Open after Saina's triumph in 2008

Tanvi negotiated a demanding draw, beating fourth seed Katethong, local favourite Yu-Hsun and Vietnam's Thuy Linh to lift the title

With the BWF World Championships in New Delhi later this month, the breakthrough offers a timely confidence boost as Tanvi prepares for the biggest test of her senior career



Golden moment: Tanvi wrapped the yellow metal around coach Tae-sang's neck after the triumph.

You get better care when you stop nodding and start asking why

Medical schools teach budding doctors to prevent disease, minimise risk, and, when in doubt, to investigate — whereas what you want out of treatment may be vastly different; when this is not discussed, a mismatch in expectations can develop, resulting in a trust deficit and disappointment

Narayana Subramaniam

Priya walks into an orthopaedician’s clinic with knee pain that she says she has had for three months. The doctor spends eight minutes with her, orders an MRI, and asks her to come back with the images. MRI shows signs of early osteoarthritis. The doctor lists three options: injections, physiotherapy or wait and watch. Priya nods, does not ask why she needed an MRI when the doctor could have examined her knee, and does not ask what ‘early osteoarthritis’ actually means or what happens if she does nothing. She opts for injections because of how she thought the doctor said it – some inflection and tone. Six months and four injections later, she has spent ₹15,000 but her pain is back. She is wondering if she got scammed, and if injections were ever the right call.

Priya was probably not scammed – but she made a decision about her body without understanding it. She did not know that she could have asked questions and she did not know that the doctor was not sure either.

Medicine is not certainty
You are taught that doctors discover diagnoses, that there is always a right answer, and that diagnoses are always objective. They are not. When the orthopaedician looked at Priya’s knee, he was thinking that the probability of osteoarthritis was 40%, a meniscal tear 30%, a muscle strain 20% and in fact a 10% chance it was something else. He did not know for certain; his estimates were based on knowledge and experience, and probably what his last 10 patients had.

The MRI showed signs of arthritis – but arthritis on imaging does not always mean it is also the cause of pain. Plenty of people have degenerative changes and feel nothing while an equal number have almost no changes and have terrible pain. Instead, the orthopaedician interpreted the image, made an educated guess, and advised treatment.

Another doctor might have looked at the same image and said, “Wait. Let us see if physiotherapy helps first.” A third doctor might have said, “This is asymptomatic degeneration. Leave it alone.”

None of them would be objectively wrong. They are all interpreting the same evidence differently based on their experience, training, risk tolerance, and – honestly – how busy their practice is and what procedures they are equipped to do. This is clinical medicine. It is not a process of discovery. It is almost always going to be a series of educated guesses filtered through a doctor’s particular worldview.

And once you understand this, you realise something: if there is no objective right answer, you need to have a say in the decision. Your life is not the doctor’s life. Your pain tolerance is not theirs. Your willingness to spend ₹15,000 on injections is not theirs.

On different tracks
Doctors are trained to approach illness in a particular way – whereas what you want out of treatment may be vastly different. When this is not discussed, a



You are taught that doctors discover diagnoses, that there is always a right answer, and that diagnoses are always objective. They are not. ISTOCKPHOTO

large mismatch in expectations can develop, resulting in a trust deficit and ultimately disappointment. Medical schools teach budding doctors to prevent disease, minimise risk, and, when in doubt, to investigate. This makes sense if you have seen someone die of a missed diagnosis. The goal becomes to not miss anything, ever. The orthopaedician was thinking: arthritis found, need to prevent progression, imaging confirms it, treat aggressively. Priya was thinking: my knee hurts, what is the quickest solution? One of them is inevitably frustrated and dissatisfied. This happens every day in Indian hospitals. A doctor sees borderline blood pressure and recommends medication. Patient thinks: I feel fine, I do not need this. Both are right. Both are wrong. That is because they are having two separate conversations. Crucially, the system does not teach doctors to fix this. As a patient, you can respond by asking questions.

A good patient
To be a good patient: First, demand clarity on usefulness. Ask “what will this tell us that changes my treatment?”, “what happens if it is normal?”, “what happens if it is abnormal?”, “how will you use this information?”, and “what are the guidelines to treat this?”. Why? A doctor who can answer gets to keep your trust. But if the doctor dodges or gets irritated, you now know something important about how they practice. Second, insist on options. Even

You know your body and yourself. The doctor knows medicine. Both of you are necessary to make a good decision. Making an informed choice is always better than a compliant one

osteoarthritis does not have just one treatment. The options include observation, physiotherapy, medications, injections, and surgery. Why? A doctor operating in good faith might say, “We could try A, which works for some people but has risks, or B, which is safer but might not work. What matters more to you?” Third, interrupt when you are confused. Do not nod and leave confused. Say “I did not follow that. Please explain it differently.” Why? Doctors do not mind. They would rather know and try again than have you leave thinking you understood.

One important question
Before any major treatment, ask: “What would you do if this was your mother?” The answer is often different from what the doctors are recommending for you. This does not mean they are being unethical; it often means something else. Maybe they do not know your full picture: your job, your life, your ability to cope with side effects. With their mother, they know all of it. Or maybe they are being more cautious with their mother not because it is better medicine but because emotion changes judgment. Or maybe they realise there are actually multiple

valid approaches and they have been presenting one option like it is the easiest one. Your doctor knows there are choices – and they may have recommended one for reasons they have not explained. So Priya could have asked, “If this was your mother’s knee, would you do four injections over six months?” The likely reply: “No. I would try physiotherapy first, and injections if that does not work.”

When you are still suffering
You followed the plan. You are compliant, you are taking your medicines, doing your exercises, and generally doing what you were told. Nothing is working. In these circumstances, you should have a different conversation, e.g.: “I am following your plan but not getting better. What does that mean?” Do not think you are accusing the doctor; you are simply investigating. Maybe the diagnosis was wrong, you need to wait longer, you need surgery or something else. You and your doctor need to figure it out together. Stop thinking your job is to obey. You know your body and yourself. The doctor knows medicine. Both of you are necessary to make a good decision. Making an informed choice is always better than a compliant one. It will also improve doctor-patient relations. As much as you deserve a good doctor, doctors also deserve good patients. (Narayana Subramaniam is Lead Consultant, Head and Neck Surgery and Oncology, Aster Hospitals, and Adjunct Faculty, Indian Institute of Science, Bengaluru. narayana.subramaniam@gmail.com)



A Greece Air Force Canadair CL-415GR water bomber aircraft drops water over a forest fire. AFP

Water-bombing aircraft helps Greece battle wildfires

Agence France Presse

Water-bombing aircraft resumed firefighting operations in Greece on Monday after winds eased, joining hundreds of firefighters battling multiple blazes that have already claimed five lives. Greece, which had largely avoided major blazes at the start of the summer unlike France and Spain, is now grappling with a second consecutive week of wildfires that have scorched thousands of hectares of forest, scrubland and farmland. “Today we are facing three difficult fronts: Psatha, Kryo Pigadi and Kandyli,” a department spokesperson said, referring to areas located between 45 and 70 kilometres west of Athens. Lighter winds allowed aerial firefighting operations to resume early on Monday, with nine water-bombing aircraft joining nine helicopters and about 450 firefighters battling the flames in the regions of Boeotia and Attica, according to the fire service.

Lighter winds allowed aerial firefighting operations to resume early on Monday, with nine water-bombing aircraft joining nine helicopters and about 450 firefighters battling the fires

In recent days, wind gusts reaching 80 kilometres per hour had grounded aircraft for safety reasons, hampering firefighting efforts. Authorities ordered new evacuations on Monday morning in villages near Kandyli, about 45 kilometres west of the capital, Greece’s Civil Protection agency said. “The battle against the fires is uneven,” Deputy Minister for Civil Protection and Climate Crisis Kostas Katsafados told public broadcaster ERTNews on Monday. The wildfires have claimed five lives since last week. On Sunday, two Bell helicopters collided while conducting firefighting operations near Psatha. A Danish pilot and a Greek co-pilot aboard one of the aircraft were killed. Their deaths followed those of three firefighters who died last week while battling separate wildfires in Crete and the Peloponnese.

‘Extremely difficult’
Prime Minister Kyriakos Mitsotakis warned that Greece faced “extremely difficult” days ahead, as high temperatures and dry conditions continued to fuel the blazes. More than 12,000 hectares of forest and agricultural land have burned over the past week, according to analyses from the European Union’s Copernicus Earth observation programme cited by local media. Greece, like much of the Mediterranean region, has experienced increasingly frequent and intense wildfires that scientists link to climate change.

Pending the outcome of an official investigation, all Bell helicopters deployed to the firefighting operation have been grounded, public broadcaster ERT reported. The helicopters were leased from Australia’s McDermott Aviation as part of a fleet of 15 aircraft. The company said it has supported operations in Greece for the past seven years. Police have arrested two employees of an electricity utility company in connection with one of the fires, which investigators believe may have been sparked on Friday by an electrical cable near the coastal village of Porto Germeno. At the height of the tourist season, authorities warned that the wildfire threat would remain “very high” on Monday. Civil Protection placed Attica, which surrounds the capital, and neighbouring Boeotia at level four on a five-point fire danger scale.

For feedback and suggestions
for ‘Science’, please write to science@thehindu.co.in with the subject ‘Daily page’

THE SCIENCE QUIZ

The chemistry of champagne and wine

Vasudevan Mukunth

QUESTION 1
Champagne is a kind of sparkling wine produced in the Champagne region of France. Name the Benedictine monk sometimes credited with inventing it on this day, August 4, in 1693. This history is not clear, however, although this monk also made well-known contributions to the quality of sparkling wine.

QUESTION 2
The process of making champagne and that of wiping the glasses it is served in leaves behind small _____ fibres. These fibres trap carbon dioxide, which later grow to become the bubbles in the liquid. Fill in the blank with the name of a material made of long chains of glucose.

QUESTION 3
When the cork of a champagne bottle is released, the gas escaping via the bottle’s neck briefly exceeds the speed of sound, producing a shockwave that is often indirectly visible in high-speed photography as a small X cloud. Name X, a process whereby water vapour cools and condenses.

QUESTION 4
The colour of red sparkling wine comes from pigment molecules in the skins of grapes called _____. Red wine gets its colour from fermenting juice with the skins on while white wine – even from red grapes – is typically pressed before coming in contact with the skin. Fill in the blank.

QUESTION 5
When wine is exposed to oxygen, it reacts



VISUAL:
Name the ‘tears of wine’ effect depicted here. It happens because at the surface, alcohol evaporates faster than water, creating a surface tension gradient that pulls liquid up in small rivulets. FLAGSTEWARD (CC BY-SA)

with compounds like tannins and volatile sulphur compounds, softening its harsh notes and releasing aromatic Y. Name Y, a compound made of an acid and an alcohol, known for its sweet smells.

Answers to July 30 quiz:
1. Planet whose debris saps the strength of its natives – **Ans: Krypton, kryptonite**
2. Synthetic alloy that’s indestructible one it has cooled – **Ans: Adamantium**
3. Light, tough metal mined in the Misty Mountains – **Ans: Mithril**
4. Room-temperature superconductor that can levitate mountains – **Ans: Unobtainium**
5. Crystalline substance that mutates organisms, releases minerals – **Ans: Tiberium**
Visual: Dilithium
First contact: Tamal Biswas | K.N. Viswanathan | Kavitha Ashu | Trisha Das | Ripudaman Singh

Text & Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Amount allocated by govt. for preservation of ASI sites

376.88 in ₹ crore. The Centre allocated ₹376.88 crore in 2025-26 for conservation, preservation and environmental development of protected monuments across the country. PTI

First tranche of interim relief released by Assam government

160 in ₹ crore. The Assam government on Monday released the first tranche of around ₹160 crore in interim relief to over 75,000 households that were the worst affected in this year's floods, officials said. PTI

Number of people kidnapped by gunmen in northwest Nigeria

52 Gunmen kidnapped at least 52 people, including children, in a weekend attack on a village and military base in northwest Nigeria's Zamfara state, sources said on Monday. Kidnappings have become a major source of income for armed groups in Nigeria. PTI

Decline in Russia's pipeline gas exports to Europe in July

5.2 in per cent. Russian energy giant Gazprom's average daily natural gas supplies to Europe via the TurkStream undersea pipeline declined 5.2% from a year earlier to 48.8 million cubic metres in July, Reuters calculations showed. REUTERS

Maharashtra: share of SIR enumeration forms distributed

93 in per cent. More than 93% of enumeration forms have been distributed, and nearly 73% digitised under the SIR of electoral rolls in Maharashtra, the Chief Electoral Officer said on Monday. PTI
COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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Why has PoK erupted in protests?

How did demands over prices evolve into a movement for greater political representation in PoK? How has Islamabad responded to the protests? What has India said about the unrest? How have international rights groups and overseas Kashmiris reacted to the crackdown?

EXPLAINER

Kallol Bhattacharjee

The story so far:

immering discontent over inflation, lack of accountability and opaque governance in Pakistan-occupied Kashmir (PoK) has escalated into a violent crackdown by Pakistani security forces over the past week, leaving dozens dead and many more injured. Security forces have reportedly used assault weapons and sniper fire against protesters gathered in the main squares of cities such as Rawalakot and Muzaffarabad to oppose the three-phase election currently under way in PoK. The Jammu Kashmir Joint Awami Action Committee (JKJAAC), which has been leading the protests, claims that more than 50 people have been killed over the past week as demonstrations continue against what it alleges is a rigged election process.

Why are protests taking place in PoK?

PoK is caught between an establishment-backed election and a popular political movement opposing the political basis of that election. The JKJAAC has been protesting peacefully in Rawalakot, Muzaffarabad, and other locations in the region seeking to build a more representative political system in PoK. The three-phase elections started on July 27 and will conclude on August 11. The movement, which emerged after the COVID-19 pandemic to curb the prices of essential items, has evolved over the years into a protest against the lack of political representation for the local population in the PoK legislature. The legislature of PoK has a total of 53 seats, out of which 45 are elected, and eight are nominated. But because of historical reasons, 12 seats out of the 45 are reserved for refugees of Indian Jammu and Kashmir who migrated after 1947. In elections for these 12 seats, refugee voters located outside PoK cast their ballots. Locals claim that the reserved seats



Supporters of the banned Joint Awami Action Committee, an alliance of civil society groups, start a fire to block a road during a protest in Muzaffarabad. REUTERS

reduce representation of communities from the region and allow Islamabad to override local concerns. As the authorities proceeded with the election process without addressing the demand for removing the reserved seats, the JKJAAC called for a "long march". Though the authorities have responded with a harsh crackdown, the protesters have shown that they are not going away anytime soon as they have managed to sustain the protests for months. The protest received new momentum after a PhD scholar, Osama Jaleel, of Quaid-e-Azam University in Islamabad, was reportedly killed in police firing in Rawalakot. Before his death, Osama Jaleel had been noted on the Internet for his fiery speeches in the protest meetings in Rawalakot. The JKJAAC claims that a total of 86 persons have died in the security crackdown till July 31.

How is the political relation between Islamabad and PoK?
The federal government of Pakistan has had a complicated relationship with the region for years, as mainstream political parties such as the Pakistan Peoples Party and Pakistan Muslim League-Nawaz have not been able to fulfil the developmental aspirations of the people of PoK. In recent days, however, the situation has worsened following comments by leading

figures within the establishment about the protesters. Pakistan Defence Minister Khwaja Asif incensed public sentiments by referring to the protesters as "enemies just like Indians". The main complaint is that the mainstream political parties in Islamabad have not met the region's developmental needs. Locals allege that they have been neglected by Islamabad, echoing many of the same complaints long voiced by residents of Khyber Pakhtunkhwa and Balochistan, where protests and insurgencies have continued for decades. The second phase of polling on August 2 drew allegations of irregularities and rigging.

What has India said about the Rawalakot protests?
Over the past few months, the Ministry of External Affairs has repeatedly condemned the use of harsh methods against protesters in Rawalakot and in other parts of PoK. On July 31, the Ministry of External Affairs blamed the 'Pakistani Establishment' and said: "This crackdown has resulted in the tragic death of over 40 civilians and serious injuries to many. Its absolute disdain for the innocent people of PoK was laid bare when their Defence Minister branded the protesting civilians as enemies." Adding to this, the Special Assistant to Prime Minister on Political Affairs openly

admitted that the very 'mujahideen' that the Pak establishment trained, armed and sent to bleed India have now turned their guns inward, weaponising themselves against the state. Mirwaiz Dr. Umar Farooq has expressed "deep concern" over the unrest across the LoC and called for dialogue. "We are deeply anguished by the continuing unrest and tragic loss of precious lives during the past month and a half," said Umar Farooq. The JKJAAC has opposed India's remarks, and in a statement on June 24, the group said it "firmly rejects any attempt by India to interpret, appropriate, or project the current situation in Azad Jammu and Kashmir in support of its own claims or geopolitical positions. The present civil rights movement is neither a proxy nor an extension of interstate rivalries. Any such characterisation is both inaccurate and misleading."

Is there a strategic dimension?
The protests have been concentrated in Rawalakot, which lies along the Line of Control, and Pakistan's response so far shows it will not tolerate instability in a region of primary importance to its security. The strategic dimension of the disturbances can be assessed by the fact that Kotli, Muzaffarabad and Rawalakot – the areas where protests have taken place hosted terror-related targets that India had claimed to have hit in the May 2025 Operation Sindoor. Apart from India, Amnesty International and influential leaders in the U.K. have also called for restraint from the Pakistani establishment. Responding to the existing communication blackout in PoK, Amnesty has said: "We urge the Pakistani authorities to restore all communications access and allow media and independent observers into the area." Non-resident Mirpuri Kashmiris, who have a strong community-level presence in the U.K., have started an online campaign to restrain Pakistan's security establishment from continuing with the repressive measures.

THE GIST

A movement that began over rising prices has evolved into a campaign against the PoK election process, with the JKJAAC demanding the removal of 12 reserved seats that it says undermine local representation. Protests have intensified amid allegations of election rigging and a deadly security crackdown; Pakistan's response has drawn criticism from India, Amnesty International and U.K.-based Kashmiri groups.

Why has West Bengal cleared land for the BSF now?

Why is West Bengal central to India's border fencing project? What are the policy challenges?

Saeed Pande

The story so far:

The West Bengal Cabinet has approved the permanent transfer of 31,905 acres at nine locations to the Border Security Force (BSF) for border fencing and related security infrastructure, along with 1.53 acres for three new Border Outposts in Malda, Nadia and Cooch Behar. The decision removes a major State-level bottleneck in a long-delayed border infrastructure project affected by land acquisition disputes, difficult terrain, and legal and political complications. The move also follows the Calcutta High Court's order of January 2026, directing the State government to hand over acquired land in nine border districts to the BSF by March 31, 2026.

Why is Bengal central to the project?
West Bengal shares the longest international border with Bangladesh among Indian States. According to the

Ministry of Home Affairs, India's 4,096.70-km border with Bangladesh includes 2,216.7 km in West Bengal, which is approximately 54% of the entire frontier. As of August 2025, 1,647.696 km had been fenced, while 569.004 km remained to be covered by fencing or other border infrastructure. Of this, 112.780 km was classified as non-feasible for conventional fencing, while 456.224 km remained technically feasible but pending completion.

Why has the project been delayed?
The delays reflect a combination of geographical, administrative and legal constraints. Nationally, the MHA reported that 3,232.218 km of the India-Bangladesh border had been fenced by August 2025, leaving 864.482 km unfenced across West Bengal (2,216.7 km), Tripura (856 km), Meghalaya (443 km), Mizoram (318 km) and Assam (263 km). Of the remaining unfenced stretch, 174.514 km has been categorised as non-feasible for conventional fencing

because of riverine channels, marshlands, floodplains, shifting river courses, densely inhabited settlements and the ecologically sensitive Sundarbans, where fencing is technically difficult and seasonally constrained. Other pending stretches require land acquisition, compensation, environmental clearances and completion of bilateral border management procedures.

What governs India-Bangladesh border fencing?
According to the Ministry of External Affairs, India undertakes border fencing and related security measures in accordance with bilateral agreements and operational protocols between the BSF and the Border Guard Bangladesh (BGB). The border is governed by the 1975 Joint India-Bangladesh Guidelines for Border Authorities, the Coordinated Border Management Plan (CBMP), 2011, and the 2015 Land Boundary Agreement (LBA), which implemented the 1974 Land Boundary Agreement and its 2011

Protocol, resolved enclave and adverse-possession disputes, and enabled the exchange of 162 enclaves, 111 Indian enclaves in Bangladesh and 51 Bangladeshi enclaves in India. India has also reiterated its expectation that these understandings will continue to support cooperation against cross-border crimes, including smuggling, human trafficking, illegal migration, arms trafficking and counterfeit currency networks.

What are the policy challenges?
This is a challenge of balancing national security with the livelihoods of communities living along the border. In districts such as Malda and Nadia, agriculture, informal trade and long-standing social ties extend across the frontier, meaning that fencing can improve surveillance while also affecting access to farmland, mobility and local commerce. As the largest unfinished segment of the India-Bangladesh border lies in West Bengal, progress and development in the State remain central to the completion of the national fencing programme. In many sectors, particularly riverine terrain, the future of border management is likely to depend on an integrated combination of physical barriers, Border Outposts, surveillance technology and coordinated action between the Union and State governments. (Saeed Pande is a freelance writer with a focus on current affairs, international relations and geopolitics)

THE GIST

The West Bengal Cabinet has approved the transfer of over 33 acres of land to the BSF for border fencing and Border Outposts, removing a long-pending bottleneck in completing security infrastructure along the India-Bangladesh border. Although more than three-fourths of the border has been fenced, progress continues to be delayed by land acquisition disputes, difficult riverine terrain, environmental constraints and legal issues, requiring a mix of fencing, surveillance technology and coordinated Union-State action.

